

CONTINUED ON >> P4

to Diluted	1.77	(1.36)	(1.99)	0.98	4.69
Notes : 1 The above standalone and consolidated Audited Financial Results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 30 th May, 2026 2 The Full format of the Financial results for the Said Quarter ended are available on www.msei.in and the same is available on the website of the Company www.radicocindia.com .					
By Order of the Board or Radico Khaitan Finance Ltd. sd/- Krishan Kumar Sharma Director DIN: 00856406					
Place : New Delhi Date : 30th May, 2026					



Govt. of Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand 25
Silver Jubilee Year
GAURAV, VIKAS AUR SANKALP KA PARV

Shri Kedarnath

Shri Gangotri

Shri Hemkund Sahib

Shri Badrinath

Shri Yamunotri



Divine and Majestic

Chardham Yatra

A WARM WELCOME TO ALL DEVOTEES

SPIRITUAL AND NATURAL ATTRACTIONS NEAR THE CHAR DHAM ROUTE

1 Near Yamunotri

Janki Chatti & Hanuman Chatti, Kharsali Village, Saptarishi Kund, Lakhamandal, Kedarkantha Trek, Rana Chatti.

2 Near Kedarnath

Bhairavnath Temple, Vasuki Tal, Gaurikund, Triyugarayan Temple, Chopta - Tungnath - Chandra Shila, Deoria Tal.

3 Near Gangotri

Gaumukh Trek, Bhojbas & Tapovan, Surya Kund & Gauri Kund, Harsil Valley, Mukhimath (Mukhba), Dayara Bugyal Trek, Gartang Gali, Kashi Vishwanath Temple (Uttarkashi), Nachiketa Tal & Dodial.

4 Near Badrinath

Mana Village, Vyas Gufa & Ganesh Gufa, Bhimsila, Auli, Valley of Flowers, Vasudhara Falls, Charanpaduka, Tapt Kund & Narad Kund, Jyotirmath (Joshimath), Satopanth Lake, Pandukeshwar, Adibadri Temple, Hemkund Sahib.



Ganesha Temple
Dodital Uttarkashi



Shani Temple
Kharsali Uttarkashi



Kandolia Temple
Pauri Garhwal



Kartik Swamy Temple
Rudrapur



Jagannath Temple
Uttarkashi



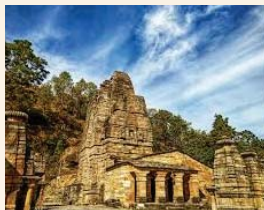
Jawalpa Devi Temple
Pauri Garhwal



Gopinath Temple
Gopeshwar, Chamoli



Kamleshwar Mahadev Temple
Srinagar Pauri Garhwal



Katarmal Sun Temple
Almora



Jageshwar Dham
Almora



Golu Devta Temple
Almora



Dunagiri Temple
Dwarahat, Almora



“The Honourable Prime Minister has termed the third decade of the 21st century as the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' In line with the Prime Minister's vision, we are working with an 'unwavering commitment' (Vikalp Rahit Sankalp) to make the state an ideal state in every field.”

Pushkar Singh Dhami, Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

Important Information

Mandatory Registration: Registration is compulsory before commencing the Yatra.
Verify Contact Details: Please ensure you enter the correct mobile number during registration.
Be Prepared for Weather: Carry adequate woolen clothes, an umbrella, and a raincoat.
Accurate Health Data: Provide precise health information during the registration process.
Senior Citizen Advisory: Senior citizens are advised to undergo a medical check-up before starting the journey.
Medication: If you are on prescribed medication, carry a sufficient stock of your medicines.
Acclimatisation: Take frequent breaks at various transit points along the route to acclimatize to the high-altitude climate.
Health First: If you feel unwell, please do not proceed with the journey.
Beware of Scams: Avoid unauthorised individuals claiming to facilitate 'Darshan' at the shrines.
Keep Tracks Clean: Cooperate with us in keeping the pilgrimage routes clean; do not litter.
Safe Driving: Maintain controlled vehicle speed and park only in designated parking areas.
No Plastic: Strictly avoid the use of single-use plastic.

Modes of Registration

Visit the website or scan the QR Code:
registrationandtouristcare.uk.gov.in



Download the App
touristcareuttarakhand



FOR ANY ASSISTANCE.
PLEASE CONTACT OUR 24X7
TOLL FREE NUMBER:
0135-3520100

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION CONTACT
PHONE:
0135-2552627
0135-2559898
E-MAIL:
touristcare.uttarakhand@gmail.com



Panch Kedar

1. Kedarnath
2. Tungnath
3. Rudranath
4. Madhmaheshwar
5. Kalpeswar

Panch Prayag

1. Devprayag
2. Rudraprayag
3. Karnprayag
4. Nandprayag
5. Vishnuprayag

Panch Badri

1. Vishal Badri
2. Yogdarshan Badri
3. Bhavya Badri
4. Vradha Badri
5. Aadi Badri

**Use only the official portal
for Helicopter Bookings
To Avoid any Fraud
www.heliyatra.irctc.co.in**



During the Chardham Yatra, you can also visit and experience the divine Panch Kedar, Panch Prayag and Panch Badri. In the Panch Badri, Lord Vishnu is worshipped in various unique forms



My dear Countrymen,

The sacred Chardham Yatra has commenced in the holy land of Devbhoomi Uttarakhand. This divine pilgrimage to the four shrines, including the darshan of Baba Kedar, is a magnificent celebration of India's eternal (Sanatan) cultural consciousness. Jagadguru Adi Shankaracharya gave a new direction to Indian culture through his pilgrimages to Badrinath and Kedarnath. Similarly, Jagadguru Ramanujacharya and Jagadguru Madhvacharya also visited Badrinath to enrich their spiritual philosophies.

Even today, these four shrines nestled in the lap of the Himalayas remain divine centers of our eternal faith and belief. Every year, people belonging to diverse languages, traditions, and cultures come here, further strengthening the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat'. This year's Yatra is an extension of that very tradition.

Our scriptures state:

**अग्निहोमादिभिर्यज्ञैरिष्टा विपुलदक्षिणैः।
न तत्फलमवाप्नोति तीर्थमिगमनेन यत्॥**

Meaning: The immense merit (Punya) earn through grand Yagyas (sacrificial rituals) and charity is profound. However, the merit obtained through a pilgrimage (Tirtha Yatra) is even greater than that gained through those rituals.

In the resolve for a 'Viksit Bharat' (Developed India), the role of a 'Viksit Uttarakhand' is extremely vital. A few years ago, at the gateway of Baba Kedar, I had said that this decade would be the 'Decade of Uttarakhand.' Today, the progress of Uttarakhand is turning that belief into reality. Uttarakhand is setting new benchmarks in all three sectors: tourism, spirituality, and economic growth.

The great ritual of development (Vikas ka Mahayagya) that has been underway in Uttarakhand for the past few years has made the Chardham Yatra more accessible, safer, and divine than ever before. This is providing great convenience to the visiting devotees, saints, and tourists. In all these efforts, every care is being taken to preserve the natural beauty of Uttarakhand.

I would also urge every guest visiting Uttarakhand to truly enjoy this new experience. During your journey, I encourage all travellers to observe a "Digital Fast" and strive to live within the natural beauty of Uttarakhand. This will provide you with a unique sense of satisfaction.

Historically, we have always traveled from our homes to Devbhoomi for the Chardham Yatra with a specific resolve. In this spirit, I wish to urge you to take Five Resolves (Panch Sankalp):

First Resolve – Cleanliness is Paramount: Maintain cleanliness within and around the shrines. Contribute your part to keeping the rivers clean. Take a pledge for a journey free of single-use plastic and uphold the dignity of this sacred land.

Second Resolve – Sensitivity towards Nature and Environment: Be sensitive toward this divine Himalayan land. While maintaining the balance of nature, contribute to environmental conservation through initiatives like 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' (A Tree in Mother's Name).

Third Resolve – Emphasis on Service, Cooperation, and Unity: Since ancient times, our pilgrimages have been a medium for universal service and social harmony. Even today, people serve pilgrims with this same spirit. I urge every pilgrim visiting the Chardham to perform at least one act of service every day of their journey. Help your fellow travellers and connect with people coming from different parts of the country. By participating in their traditions, strengthen the spirit of 'Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat' through this pilgrimage.

Fourth Resolve – Promoting 'Vocal for Local': From the time you leave your home until you return, ensure that you spend at least five percent of your total travel budget on purchasing local products. Even if a local item is not immediately needed in this season, try to buy it for future use.

Fifth Resolve – Adherence to Discipline, Safety, and Decorum: Follow the rules of the journey and traffic instructions. As a responsible and alert citizen, make this pilgrimage safe and accessible. Let us ensure that our journey does not cause any inconvenience to the people involved in the organisation and management of this Yatra.

In recent years, a large number of creators and influencers have started visiting the Chardham. I urge all of you to make an effort to share the local stories of Uttarakhand and its small, unique traditions with the masses.

May the blessings of Baba Kedar and all the four shrines infuse your life with new energy, new inspiration, and new resolutions. This is my wish for you.

My heartiest best wishes to all of you for a successful, safe, divine, and soulful journey.

Yours

Narendra Modi



Haryana assures 1,000 cusecs water via Munak canal: CM Rekha

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

As water shortages deepened across large parts of Delhi, with residents in several neighbourhoods reporting dry taps for days, mounting dependence on tankers and growing concerns over contamination, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Saturday the Haryana Government has assured supply of 1,000 cusecs of water through Munak Canal.

The chief minister also said that more than 980 tankers making over 6,000 daily trips are being deployed to ease the crisis.

Additionally, by establishing additional borewells in the Yamuna Khadar area, water production capacity has been increased by 10.5



MGD per day. Earlier, the chief minister held a detailed review meeting on drinking water challenges and water supply situation with Delhi Jal Board (DJB) officials through video conferencing from the Chief Minister Seva Sadan. Water Minister Pravesh Sahib Singh, Delhi Jal

Board Vice Chairperson Satish Upadhyay, Member Ajay Mahawar, Chief Secretary Rajiv Verma, Delhi Jal Board Chief Executive Officer Vijay Bidhuri and other senior officials were present in the meeting. "To tackle the water-related challenges, an assurance has

been given by Haryana to maintain a minimum of 1,000 cusecs of water supply through the Munak Canal," she said after speaking to Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini.

Being a landlocked city, Delhi is dependent on neighbouring states of Haryana and Uttar Pradesh for raw water supply. DJB's overall average production capacity ranges between 990 and 1,000 million gallons per day (MGD) of drinking water, including the tubewells.

The chief minister also said that efforts are being made to provide relief to the people through more than 980 tankers and over 6,000 daily trips.

In the past several days, the DJB had been struggling to maintain its average water

production which has fallen by around 90 million gallons per day (MGD) from its target of 1,002 MGD this year.

In the past week, the DJB received 11,055 complaints on its helpline, out of which more than 8,500 complaints have been resolved, claimed officials.

"In the past few days, the DJB was receiving around 900 to 924 cusecs of water through the Munak Canal, the neighbouring state has assured to provide 100 cusecs more than the allocated amount of 924 cusecs to Delhi," a DJB official said.

Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the water level at Wazirabad has fallen from its normal pond level of 674.5 feet to nearly 668 feet, resulting in a shortage of raw water and affecting

water production by nearly 80-100 MGD.

"The water level at Wazirabad has fallen from its normal pond level of 674.5 feet to nearly 668 feet, resulting in a shortage of raw water and affecting water production by nearly 80-100 MGD. This situation has been aggravated by the prolonged dry spell in the upper reaches of the Yamuna." Emergency pumping arrangements have also been installed in the dry riverbed, contributing nearly 40 MGD of additional raw water. Along with around 130 MGD being diverted from the canal system, these measures have helped sustain operations at the Wazirabad and Chandrawal Water Treatment Plants, "Singh added. The Chief Minister directed the officials to take

immediate action considering every incident of water leakage seriously.

The chief minister directed the officials to take immediate action by considering every incident of water leakage seriously.

"Every single drop of water is precious and any kind of wastage will not be acceptable. The Government is paying equal attention to immediate relief measures as well as long-term solutions so that the water crisis can be permanently controlled in the future," the chief minister said in a statement.

The chief minister also said that the DJB will be roping in IIT Roorkee to conduct a feasibility study of bringing water through a pipeline from Haryana as a long-term effort.

Delhi Zoo expands cooling facilities to beat heat

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Zoological Park has introduced a two-shift rotation system for animals and expanded cooling facilities, including pools, sprinklers and shaded shelters, to protect wildlife from Delhi's intense summer heat.

An official said tigers, lions, and bears share an enclosure in two shifts: 7 am to 1 pm and 1 pm onwards. This schedule reduces prolonged heat exposure and ensures each animal gets adequate access to cooling and shade, he said.

Zoo Director Sanjeet Kumar said that animals are taken to pools in shifts.

To maintain hygiene, stagnant water in moats is regularly cleaned, disinfected and refilled, he said.

"Shade structures over water pools prevent water from overheating, while sprinklers and water coolers are operational in all enclosures, including those for tigers, lions and leopards," Kumar said. He said green mats have been installed in several enclosures to reduce direct sunlight.



Class 11 student stabbed over bike dispute dies in Ghaziabad; three arrested

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A 17-year-old Class 11 student who was stabbed during an altercation in Ghaziabad on May 28 died during treatment at a private hospital in Noida on Friday, police said. The police added that three of the five accused have been arrested, and raids are underway to trace the two who are still at large.



Surya Chauhan FILE PHOTO

The deceased, Surya Chauhan, was a resident of Navnet Vihar Colony in Khoda. He was stabbed in the abdomen on the afternoon of May 28 after being called to a meeting spot. He died around noon on Friday, nearly two days after the attack. ACP Indirapuram Abhishek Srivastava said police were alerted at around 3:30 pm on May 28 and rushed the injured teenager to a hospital. He was subsequently referred to a private hospital in Noida, where he succumbed to his injuries.

DCP City Dhawal Jaiswal said preliminary investigation suggests the accused and the deceased were known to each other. A dispute had broken out between the two sides over riding a motorcycle, which escalated into a heated argument. In a fit of anger, one of the accused allegedly stabbed Chauhan, the officer said.

The family's account of the attack is more harrowing than the initial dispute suggests. According to Chauhan's family members, he received a phone call asking him to come to a meeting spot on the afternoon of May 28. He went there with his friends.

An argument broke out, following which he was stabbed in the abdomen. Chauhan ran nearly 200 metres in an attempt to save his life, but the assailants chased him and attacked him again with knives. DCP Jaiswal confirmed that police are conducting raids to nab the main accused, who had called the victim to the meeting spot.

Among the three arrested is a person from whom the knife used in the crime was procured, the officer said. Acting on a complaint lodged by Chauhan's family, police have arrested the three accused, and efforts are underway to arrest the remaining two.

Bahujan Samaj Party chief Mayawati termed the incident extremely tragic and worrying. In a post on X, she said the Government and administration must take effective steps to prevent such incidents and demanded that the culprits be brought to justice swiftly. She also cautioned that such crimes could have wider repercussions with Uttar Pradesh heading to polls next year and urged the Government to remain fully vigilant.

MCD revives Jangpura pet park project, tenders issued now

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Dog lovers have a reason to rejoice with the national capital will get its first dedicated pet park later this year, as the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) revives a nearly two-year-long-pending project in Jangpura, which has remained non-operational since its initial development.

Fresh tenders for the facility, spread across around 1.5 acres near the Jangpura-Defence Colony flyover, were issued earlier this month. The civic body is appointing a private operator under the public-private partnership (PPP) model who will manage the facility and develop additional amenities. "Last time, we could not find a suitable second party to carry out the



operations of the project. This time, we are certain that an agency will be finalised within the next two to three weeks," an MCD official said.

Officials said the facility is expected to become operational once an agency is finalised to run and maintain the park and will accommodate more than 20 dogs at a time. The park, planned as a comprehensive

pet-friendly space, will include dedicated exercise and play zones, dog trails, swimming and tracking areas, grooming and medical facilities, and a day-care centre for working pet owners.

Officials said the facility is designed with safety measures such as double-gated entry points to prevent dogs from accidentally running out of the premises. "The project is under process, and we are certain that the facility will be opened in the next few months after the operational arrangements are put in place," the official said.

The pet park was originally developed in early 2023 as a multi-purpose space offering recreational, veterinary and day-care services for pet dogs. However, despite the

completion of basic infrastructure, the facility never opened to the public due to delays in appointing an operator, officials said.

Officials aware of the matter said the project was initially held up because the MCD Standing Committee, which was required to approve rates and offers submitted through the tendering process, was not constituted.

Even after a committee was formed in 2025, the proposal remained pending. Under the first phase of development were repurposed to house a veterinary clinic, grooming centre and cafeteria. The civic body earlier stated that entry to the facility will be regulated, allowing only registered and vaccinated pet dogs inside.

Nausena Shaurya Vatika to inspire youths: CM Yogi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Lucknow

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said on Saturday that the newly inaugurated 'Nausena Shaurya Vatika' in Lucknow would inspire youth, strengthen patriotic values, and offer visitors a chance to understand the Indian Navy's role, sacrifices and technological capabilities.

Addressing a gathering after inaugurating the facility along with Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Adityanath said the Naval-themed memorial and open-air museum was jointly developed by the Indian Navy and the Uttar Pradesh Government and would become a significant attraction in the State Capital.

Welcoming Singh to his



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh with UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and State Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak greet the gathering in Lucknow PTI

parliamentary constituency, the chief minister thanked Indian Navy Chief Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi and his team for completing the project within the stipulated timeframe in collaboration with the state Government. Adityanath said visitors coming to Lucknow would now witness not only India's cultural heritage and traditions but also a centre showcasing the country's defence capabilities.

Referring to the warship INS Gomati, the museum's centrepiece, he said the vessel safeguarded India's maritime interests for years before being decommissioned in 2022 and now inspires future generations on the banks of the Gomti River.

Phones buzz in Delhi-NCR with 'Extremely Severe Alert'

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Millions of mobile phones buzzed across Delhi-NCR and parts of western Uttar Pradesh on Saturday after receiving an "Extremely Severe Alert" notification on their mobile phones, accompanied by a loud warning buzzer. The alert warned of severe weather conditions, including thunderstorms, lightning, strong winds, heavy rain-fall and hailstorms, likely to affect several districts over the next few hours.

The message stated: "Severe Thunderstorm (wind speed 60-80 kmph, gusting to 90 kmph) with Lightning and Moderate to Intense Spell of Rain and Hail is very likely to occur at a few places over Aligarh, Baghpat, Bulandshahr, Gautam Buddh Nagar, Ghaziabad, Hapur, Mathura and Meerut in the next three hours."

The emergency notification triggered concern among many residents, with several taking to social media to share screenshots of the alert and express surprise over the loud alarm tone that accompanied the message. The alert was part of the government's cell broadcast warning system, designed to rapidly

Extremely severe alert

अगले 3 घंटों के दौरान आपके जनपद के कुछ स्थानों पर बिजली कड़कने के साथ तेज़ आंधी-तूफान (हवा की गति 60-80 किमी/घंटा, जो बढ़कर 90 किमी/घंटा) और मध्यम से तेज़ बारिश व ओलावृष्टि होने की संभावना है।

OK

disseminate emergency weather information to people located in potentially affected areas. The national Capital saw a further drop in the minimum temperature on Saturday, as the air quality improved to the satisfactory category, amidst heavy winds and light to moderate rain in several parts of the city.

A yellow alert issued by the India Meteorological Department (IMD) remained in place for Saturday and Sunday as well. Palam recorded a minimum temperature of 21.5 degrees Celsius.

Delhi Police Special Cell dismantles ISI-Dawood...

They explicitly shortlisted targets: Nuclear installations, major airports, railway stations, power plants, Government offices, security buildings, and crowded religious or public places in central Delhi, Shukla said.

Their plans included suicide bombings, grenade attacks, and mass shootings at security personnel. The group had finalised logistics and awaited their handlers' signal when the Special Cell intervened. The raids netted a significant cache of weapons, including several hand grenades.

Investigators found sophisticated explosives in their possession, while some were traced to Pakistan-origin consignments. They also discovered Pakistan-made cartridges, assorted firearms, and advanced ammunition. Digital evidence included videos and geo-tags of every target. Police teams are now analysing the explosive materials and investigating the smuggling routes, believed to involve drone drops or Hawala couriers.

"Specific intelligence inputs revealed ISI had revived its 'white-collar' terror infrastructure along with D-Company, aiming to exploit urban vulnerabilities. Pakistani intelligence operatives cultivated the module over a prolonged period", Shujla said.

A detailed multi-agency investigation is ongoing on Hawala networks, youth recruitment, logistical support, sleeper cells, and command chains linking Pakistani handlers to street-level operatives, he added. The National Security alert has been escalated. Police in Delhi and Mumbai are on maximum alert. All sensitive sites, including the Red Fort (scene of last year's vehicle-borne IED attack that killed 15), airports, and religious sites, now have extra paramilitary forces.

Central agencies like NIA, IB, and RAW are coordinating with state units. The bust coincides with new intelligence about Pakistan-based groups reviving terror infrastructure. This follows recent setbacks, including last month's deportation and arrest of Dawood's lieutenant, Mohammad Salim Dola, from Turkey.

Security experts call this a textbook case of ISI-underworld convergence, as India warned on global forums. Investigations continue, and India's counter-terror forces remain vigilant, but the Pakistan-based threat persists.

2 men freed after 20 years, Special Cell case...

Its investigators alleged that Qamar and Ali had actually been picked up weeks before their formal date of arrest and held in illegal detention. The agency found that the alleged recovery of arms and explosives appeared to be fabricated. It found no credible evidence linking the two men to Al-Badr.

The prosecution, the High Court noted, failed to effectively rebut any of this during the trial. Call data records and other material discussed by the CBI were never convincingly challenged. The CBI report was never answered. It simply sat in the record, uncontroverted, while the prosecution pressed on with a case built on evidence the court found insufficient at every stage.

The bench underlined a principle that carries weight beyond this specific case. Appellate courts, it said, should interfere with acquittals only when the trial court's findings are perverse or wholly unsustainable. Here, it held, the trial court's view was both possible and plausible. Acquittal strengthens the presumption of innocence, the court noted, and criminal cases must be decided strictly on unimpeachable evidence, not suspicion.

Abhishek attacked by locals during West...

Another added, "Where was he when the Abhaya incident happened? We want an answer from him." Meanwhile, BJP West Bengal president Samik Bhattacharya said the incident could be the outcome of the anger of locals who were "tortured" over the years. The BJP is not involved in such activities. What has happened is not expected in a democracy," Bhattacharya told reporters. "I can't say why the police were absent;

it's an administration issue.

Over the years, TMC targeted our workers. We remember what they did to Rupa Ganguly and other leaders in South 24 Parganas. We are restrained, and that's why TMC remains," he added. A large team of central forces and Sonarpur police arrived to control the situation and escort Banerjee out, police said. TMC supreme and former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee on Saturday strongly condemned the attack on party national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee at Sonarpur, alleging that the BJP was behind the incident.

The Congress on Saturday strongly condemned the attack on TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee in Sonarpur, West Bengal. It said the deliberate lack of adequate police protection for a prominent opposition leader speaks volumes about the BJP's politics of "vendetta and persecution".

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said, "Strongly condemn the shocking attack on MP Abhishek Banerjee in Sonarpur, as he went to meet the families affected by post-poll violence in the State. "The deliberate lack of adequate police protection for a prominent Opposition leader speaks volumes about the BJP's politics of vendetta and persecution," the Congress president said.

Technical glitch delays CUET-UG 2026 exam

"The issue was promptly identified and resolved by our technical teams, and the examination has since resumed without any impact on the sanctity of the exam. We regret the inconvenience," the statement said.

It added that its teams are "actively monitoring all systems" and remain committed to working closely with the NTA "to ensure seamless conduct of the computer-based tests." Several students and parents reported the delay on the social media platform X and alleged a lack of communication at the examination centres. The Common University Entrance Test-Undergraduate, or CUET-UG, is a standardised, national-level entrance exam conducted by the NTA for admissions into undergraduate

degree programmes across central, state, and select private universities.

The CUET-UG has been conducted in the computer-based test (CBT) mode since the 2025 cycle, with the NTA citing improved standardisation, efficiency and logistics in the conduct of the nationwide entrance test.

DKS set to for Govt

Over the years, the 64-year-old leader steadily positioned himself as the Congress party's principal Vokkaliga strongman.

The Vokkaligas are among Karnataka's dominant agrarian communities. The Congress high command tested Shivakumar's political management skills in 2017 by assigning him the responsibility of safeguarding 42 Gujarat Congress MLAs in Bengaluru ahead of the Rajya Sabha elections to prevent cross-voting. He lived up to the expectations of the party leadership, as Congress candidate Ahmed Patel won the election in Gujarat.

His organisational skills, political resilience and commitment to the party impressed the Congress high command, which appointed him Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee president in 2020. Shivakumar took charge at a difficult phase for the Congress in Karnataka. The party had performed poorly in the 2018 Assembly elections, and the setback deepened in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls, when the Congress managed to win just one of 28 seats in the state amid the Narendra Modi wave.

Not all immigrants to leave US...

The spokesperson pointed to people who overstay visas or come from countries whose citizens are heavy users of public assistance as groups that could be affected.

Despite the assurances, immigration lawyers have been counselling a wait and watch approach to see how the changes actually unfold as fewer details were immediately available.

Though announced with a news release, a senior White House official said this week that

the effort was meant to be a housekeeping matter, not a change of strategy, the New York Times reported. About 14 lakh green cards were granted in 2024, with more than 8.2 lakh approved for people inside the country through a process called "adjustment of status", according to Department of Homeland Security data.

Over the past two decades, more than 500,000 people have received green cards via adjustment of status each year, except for in 2020 during the Covid-19 pandemic.

According to estimates, over 30,000 Indian H1B visa holders become due for green cards every year. Despite the assurances, immigration lawyers have been counselling a wait and watch approach to see how the changes actually unfold.

Trump yet to seal Iran deal

Iran's main negotiator said on Friday that it has "no trust in guarantees or words", only actions, underscoring lingering distrust after the US and Israel have twice attacked Iran over the past year while it was engaged in nuclear negotiations.

"No step will be taken before the other side acts," Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf wrote on X. "We do not gain concessions through talks, but through missiles."

Later, but before Trump's meeting concluded, Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei told a state broadcaster that the agreement "has not been finalised yet". On Thursday, US Vice President JD Vance suggested negotiators were trying to strike general terms on Iran's nuclear programme, with the specifics to be hammered out in the ensuing talks.

Baghaei, however, said on Friday that Iranian officials were "focussed on the end of war and are not discussing the details of the nuclear plan at this point".

Iran also wants any deal to include a truce between Israel and Iran-backed Hezbollah militants in Lebanon, where fighting has intensified despite a nominal ceasefire. And the Islamic Republic has been seeking the release of billions of dollars in frozen funds.

Navy Chief pitches for maritime theatre command

MANASH PRATIM BHUYAN
■ New Delhi

Navy Chief Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi on Saturday strongly pitched for a dedicated naval theatre command combining capabilities of all three services and the coast guard as he cited the West Asia conflict to underline that maritime security is directly linked to energy security and national resilience.

In an exclusive interview with PTI, Admiral Tripathi said theaterisation must remain strictly guided by operational effectiveness and enhancement of national military capability rather than organisational restructuring alone.

Framing military jointness as a combat necessity rather than a concept, the Navy Chief said any new joint structure must prioritise maritime realities while fully aligning with broader national objectives of integrated warfighting.

In view of the unfolding crisis in West Asia, the setting up of a dedicated naval

theatre command incorporating assets and personnel from the Army, Navy, Air Force and the Coast Guard has gained traction. The overarching blueprint envisions two additional theatre commands to manage the Northern and Western fronts.

Admiral Tripathi also argued that the ongoing instability in West Asia and the Russia-Ukraine conflict serve as "stark reminders" that security is interconnected, and distance from conflict does not equate to distance from its consequences.

"The first and most critical lesson is that maritime security is directly linked to economic security, energy security and national resilience," he said.

"Disruptions to shipping routes, energy flows, and maritime logistics chains have immediate strategic and economic consequences, affecting insurance costs, shipping patterns and the strategic balance across entire regions," he said.

The Navy Chief said the



character of warfare itself is undergoing a profound transformation and that the maritime battlespace today extends seamlessly from seabed to space, while cyber, electromagnetic, information and cognitive domains have become equally vital.

Modern conflict is increasingly defined by speed, scale and simultaneity. Speed is no longer just an enabler; it is a distinct capability, he noted.

The Navy Chief, citing the

recent conflicts, also said that the myth of short and swift wars has been debunked and that strategic depth no longer guarantees sanctuary in an era of long-range precision weapons and persistent surveillance.

"Additionally, the weaponisation of tariffs and the disruption to interdependent supply chains require nations to shift their logistics from "Just-in-Time" efficiency to "Just-in-Case" resilience," he said.

"To build a future-ready force, the Indian Navy is aggressively incorporating AI, quantum technologies and autonomous solutions across all domains in line with the Indian Navy Roadmap for Uncrewed Systems," he said.

Admiral Tripathi said the Indian Navy's future fleet will not be defined by platforms alone, but by the integrated effects it can generate, utilising an optimum mix of low-cost, high-impact uncrewed solutions alongside high-end crewed platforms.

"We are continuously refining our operational concepts, training methodologies, space-based communications and cyber resilience to ensure our people can operate in a highly transparent, contested and data-driven environment," he said.

The Navy Chief said the past year has been a definitive testament to his force's commitment to being a first responder and a preferred security partner.

"In an increasingly inter-

connected and contested maritime environment, the Indian Navy maintained an unprecedented operational tempo across our areas of interest — clocking nearly 11,000 ship days and over 50,000 flying hours in 2025 alone," he said.

"Foremost among these achievements was Operation Sindoor, which demonstrated our absolute combat readiness, operational reach and deterrence potential."

"The immediate deployment of a Carrier Battle Group and our forward operational posture in the Northern Arabian Sea forced the Pakistan Navy to remain confined to harbour or close to the Makran coast," he said.

This aggressive posturing, Admiral Tripathi said, reaffirmed the Navy's ability to rapidly position combat power and successfully shape the strategic environment, while simultaneously impacting their maritime economy due to increased shipping risks and elevated insurance premiums. (PTI)

Himanta meets PM, seeks guidance for Assam Govt



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Saturday paid a courtesy visit to Prime Minister Narendra Modi at his official residence in New Delhi. The meeting marked Sarma's first formal interaction with the Prime Minister after assuming office as Chief Minister for a second consecutive term.

During the meeting, the Chief Minister briefed the Prime Minister on the initial progress and priorities of the newly formed NDA 3.0 Government in Assam.

Sarma also expressed gratitude to PM Modi for his continued support and leadership, while seeking his guidance and blessings for the State's future development initiatives.

Sharing details of the meeting on social media platform X, Sarma wrote, "Honoured to call upon Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji in New Delhi today. I briefed him on the head-start we are making in the NDA 3.0 Government in Assam, thanked him for his unstinted support and sought his continued blessings and guidance in the coming years."

Delhi court frames MCOCA charges against Sukesh Chandrasekhar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court has framed charges against conman Sukash Chandrasekhar, his wife Leena Paulose, and 19 other accused persons in the ₹217 crore extortion case, invoking the Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act against all 21 accused. The development comes in the case that had drawn national attention after Bollywood actress Jacqueline Fernandez was named in a related money laundering investigation by the Enforcement Directorate for allegedly receiving expensive gifts purchased from the proceeds of the crime.

Special Judge Prashant

Sharma of the MCOCA Court at Patiala House Courts, New Delhi, framed charges on May 30, 2026, under multiple sections of the Indian Penal Code covering cheating, extortion, forgery, criminal conspiracy, and impersonation, along with Section 66 of the Information Technology Act and Sections 3 and 4 of MCOCA. The case pertains to FIR No. 208/2021 registered at PS Special Cell and subsequently investigated by Delhi Police's Economic Offences Wing.

Additional Commissioner of Police, Economic Offences Wing, Ravi Kumar Singh, described the development as a landmark moment in a four-year investigation. "The framing of charges under



MCOCA in this highly significant and complex case marks a major milestone and reflects the strength of the evidence collected during the investigation," Singh said.

Chandrasekhar ran his illegal extortion business from Tihar Jail in connivance

with jail officials. Impersonating himself as a senior government official including the Union Home Secretary, Union Law Secretary, and officers from the Prime Minister's Office, he contacted Aditi Singh, wife of former Ranbaxy promoter

Shivinder Mohan Singh, and extorted more than Rs 200 crore from her over a period of one year on the pretext of a contribution to party funds.

The EOW filed a chargesheet naming 14 accused, including Chandrasekhar and his wife Leena Maria Paul, in 2021, with charges under IPC provisions and MCOCA. The accused allegedly used hawala routes and shell companies to park money earned from the proceeds of crime.

The case widened significantly when the Enforcement Directorate named actress Jacqueline Fernandez in a supplementary chargesheet in connection with money laundering linked to the same extortion proceeds.

Centre unveils AI Chatbot Samadhan Didi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Centre on Saturday unveiled an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled chatbot to help citizens raise grievances against Government departments online.

Launching the chatbot named 'Samadhan Didi', Union Minister of State for Personnel Jitendra Singh termed it as "democratisation of the public grievance mechanism" in the nation, showcasing the Government's unwavering commitment to enhancing the ease of using public services for citizens.

The chatbot marks a significant step towards



making public grievance redressal simpler, more accessible and truly multilingual, he said.

A citizen can now lodge a grievance simply by speaking, in their own language, describing the concern in plain words, without needing to know which ministry/department, cat-

egory or sub-category it belongs to, Singh said.

The chatbot understands the concern, asks a few relevant clarifying questions, automatically identifies the appropriate ministry, department, category and sub-category, and files the grievance with the correct authority, the minister said.



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States Focus



ASSAM WORKER BEATEN TO DEATH BY MOB IN TAMIL NADU

A migrant labourer from Assam was beaten to death by a mob in Thiruvallur district after he allegedly misbehaved with a woman, police said on Saturday. The victim has been identified as Prosenjit Das (35), who, along with six labourers from Assam, came to Thiruvallur in search of employment and were staying in a rented room, they said. Preliminary inquiry revealed that Das, who was under the influence of alcohol, misbehaved with a woman under the pretext of asking for drinking water at her residence on Friday evening. However, the woman was forced to shut the door and go inside her house for safety. When the accused began damaging the windows with a knife, the woman called her relatives.

(PTI)



AIADMK DEMANDS ACTION OVER ALLEGED HORSE-TRADING

AIADMK whip Agri SS Krishnamoorthy met Tamil Nadu Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar at Lok Bhavan here on Saturday and requested him to take action against the alleged "horse-trading" by the ruling TVK, following the resignation of four AIADMK MLAs. AIADMK legislators – K Maragatham Kumaravel (Maduranthakam Assembly constituency), S Jayakumar (Perundurai), P Sathyabama (Dharapuram) and Esakki Subaya (Ambasamudram) resigned as MLAs and joined the TVK. They were among the rebel AIADMK MLAs who voted in favour of the TVK Government in the Assembly during the floor test on May 13. In a petition submitted to the Governor, the AIADMK claimed that "huge sums of money were transacted to lure party MLAs" and sought a CBI enquiry, a party release said.

(PTI)

Demographic shift in border districts biggest threat: Shah

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Ahmedabad

Union Home Minister Amit Shah has termed the demographic changes in border districts as "the most serious challenge" before the country, and called for strict monitoring and reporting of these developments.

Shah, who chaired a security review meeting at Bhuj in Gujarat's Kutch district, located along the India-Pakistan border, also stated that administrations of border districts should formulate SOPs to ensure identification of existing infiltrators and the tracking of threats related to drones and narcotics, said an official release. Demographic changes in the border districts pose the most serious challenge, and district magistrates should ensure strict monitoring and regular reporting of such developments, Shah was quoted as saying in the release issued on Saturday.

Notably, earlier this week, the Union home minister announced the formation of a high-level committee to assess demographic changes across India due to "illegal



Union Home Minister Amit Shah

immigration and other unnatural causes" and suggest measures to deal with the issue.

At the review meeting, Shah emphasised the need to adopt a zero-tolerance approach towards unauthorised encroachment within the 0 to 15 km belt along the international border and to maintain a close watch on centres of radicalisation in border areas.

Shah called reverse migration happening in border areas due to the establishment of industrial units a welcome development and said that everyone, from police stations to patwaris

(village revenue officials), should work in unison to ensure deportation of the existing illegal infiltrators.

He also called for the need to form Security Coordination Groups in every such district, comprising the BSF, Coast Guard, Enforcement Directorate (ED), and the managers of leading banks in the area.

The responsibility for the effective enforcement of Income Tax, anti-money laundering and Customs laws should rest with the District Magistrate, Superintendent of Police and Inspector General (IG), Border Range, said the Union minister.

He also highlighted the need to maintain strict vigil over hawala transactions, financial dealings, mule accounts, shell companies, suspicious vehicles and GST collections in border districts.

Agencies dealing with financial crimes must be kept apprised regarding border areas, and the Income Tax Department, in collaboration with the RBI, should conduct extensive survey campaigns, Shah said. He also called for the need to prioritise coastal security and ensure effective coordination with the Indian Coast Guard, given Kutch's proximity to the International Maritime Boundary Line (IMBL). Alongside the 'Vibrant Villages' initiative, 100 per cent saturation of every scheme, both of the Central and State Government, must be ensured in border villages, Shah said.

Border fencing, maritime border security and strong political will of the State Government have brought about a significant transformation in Gujarat's security landscape, resulting in the complete cessation of infiltration and smuggling on the border, he noted.

Future belongs to sustainable economies: VP Radhakrishnan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Panaji

Vice President CP Radhakrishnan on Saturday said the future belongs to those economies that can attain growth while preserving the ecological balance, and noted that Goa has the potential to emerge as a national model for sustainable coastal development.

Speaking at the Goa Statehood Day celebration event in Panaji, he said Goa was well-placed to lead the country in the emerging blue economy sector.

Describing the coastal state as an inspiring model for the rapidly changing world, he said it has demonstrated that one can embrace modernity without losing cultural roots and while preserving local traditions. Goa Governor P Ashok Gajapathi Raju and Chief Minister Dr Pramod Sawant were also present on the occasion. "The future belongs to economies that can grow while preserving ecological balance, and Goa can emerge as a national model for sustainable coastal development," Radhakrishnan said.



Vice President CP Radhakrishnan being felicitated by Goa CM Pramod Sawant during the 40th Goa Statehood Day celebration in Panaji

PTI

Will help Marathas without injustice to OBCs, says Fadnavis

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Nagpur

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Saturday said his Government was positive towards fulfilling the demands of the Maratha community on the reservation issue, and will continue to take decisions in its interest while also ensuring that the OBCs do not face injustice.

He also said the Government will take deci-



sions on the quota issue that can stand the test of the Constitution and courts, and survive legal scrutiny. According to Fadnavis, rising

fuel prices were linked to the global energy crisis, and the rates would stabilise once the international situation improves.

Speaking to reporters after inspecting a compressed biogas plant at Bhandewadi in Nagpur, Fadnavis was asked about Maratha quota activist Manoj Jarange's indefinite hunger strike, which he launched in Antarwali Sarati village in Jalna district on Saturday morning. This time, he is fasting in the open

without any canopy or protective shelter despite the intense heat.

Jarange has renewed his demand for the issuance of Kunbi caste certificates to members of the Maratha community to avail the OBC quota, implementation of the Hyderabad and Satara Gazette records, and withdrawal of cases registered against Maratha protesters who participated in the reservation agitation. Fadnavis said, "The

Government has always been positive on this issue. Whenever difficulties arose, the Government took decisions. The Government's stand is transparent and positive, and it will remain positive in the future as well."

The CM said his Government works for all communities and does not create conflict between social groups. "The decisions taken by Eknath Shinde and me for the Maratha community have never been taken before in

history. We will continue to take decisions in the community's interest," he said.

However, he stressed that any decision on reservation-related issues must be in line with the Constitution and court directives.

"We have to follow the Constitution and the directions given by the high court and the Supreme Court. A decision taken outside that framework may bring publicity, but it will not survive legal scrutiny," he said.

सत्यमेव जयते

दिल्ली सरकार

पुण्यश्लोक

लोकमाता

अहिल्याबाई

होल्कर जी

की जयंती पर

उनके अद्वितीय शासन, सेवा और धर्मनिष्ठा को नमन

नरेन्द्र मोदी

प्रधानमंत्री

रेखा गुप्ता

मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

Centre gives ₹2,103 cr for health mission in West Bengal: CM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Kolkata

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Saturday said the State is set to implement the National Health Mission, and the Centre has sanctioned ₹2,103 crore for the scheme.

Addressing a programme of the health department in Kolkata, Adhikari also said that over 1.36 crore families will be covered under the Ayushman Bharat scheme in Bengal.

"This will ensure that a large section of the population in the State receives quality healthcare support," he said.



Evict me by force: Rabri refuses to vacate Government bungalow

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Patna

Former Bihar chief minister Rabri Devi on Saturday dared CM Samrat Choudhary to evict her "by force" from the Government bungalow that she has been occupying for over a decade.

The RJD leader, who had an eight-year tenure as the CM from 1997 to 2005, blew a fuse when a couple of journalists asked her about an order of the building construction department that allotted the 10, Circular Road bungalow in Patna to Dairy and Fisheries minister Nand Kishor Ram.

"Yes, I can see that Samrat Choudhary, who has become the chief minister only recently, is quite excited. Let him get me evicted by force. I am not going to vacate the premises", said the indignant wife of RJD president Lalu Prasad.

Rabri Devi was asked about the development at



the airport here, upon return from a short vacation in Delhi, where she celebrated the birthday of her grandson and from where her husband is said to have left for Singapore for medical treatment.

The former chief minister, who loves to keep reminding Choudhary that he began his career as a minister in her Cabinet, spoke to media persons from inside her car and shoved aside their mics in a fit of rage.

The family had been allotted the 10, Circular Road bungalow, a stone's throw from Raj Bhavan and

the chief minister's residence, by the previous Nitish Kumar Government.

The bungalow, besides housing the RJD's proverbial first family, has for years served as the Opposition party. A few months ago, before Choudhary took over as the first BJP CM of the State, an order was passed by the building construction department stating that the bungalow shall be henceforth allotted only to a deputy CM, and Rabri, in her capacity as the Leader of the Opposition in the State legislature council, was asked to shift to a different house on Harding Road.

Forces ready for OP Sindoor 2.0 if needed: Army Chief

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE Pune

The armed forces are fully prepared for 'Operation Sindoor 2.0' if the need arises, Chief of Army Staff General Upendra Dwivedi said on Saturday, asserting that all three services are enhancing synergy for modern multi-domain warfare that extends beyond land, air and sea.

Speaking at a press conference on the sidelines of the passing-out parade of the 150th course of the National Defence Academy (NDA) in Pune, General Dwivedi noted that while a temporary cessation of hostilities currently exists, all three services are preparing intensely for the next phase should it take place.

India launched Operation Sindoor, a military exercise to destroy terror infrastructure in Pakistan in May 2025, in response to the



Chief of the Army Staff (COAS) General Upendra Dwivedi interacting with trainees during the passing-out parade of the 150th course of the National Defence Academy (NDA) in Pune, Maharashtra

PTI

Pahalgalam terror attack, which claimed 26 lives in April. "As far as Operation Sindoor is concerned, firstly, it is still continuing. There is a temporary cessation of hostilities. So the Indian Army and all three services are preparing well for Operation Sindoor 2.0 if it takes place," he said. He noted that future conflicts

would increasingly be influenced by emerging domains such as space, cyber and cognitive warfare.

Modern battlefields have become highly transparent, General Dwivedi said, adding that military planners must remain cautious about deployments and force protection measures. "What we have seen over a period of

time is 24/7. The battlefield is so transparent that every movement is known to the other side. Therefore, we have to be very cautious in terms of our deployment, in terms of our employment, and the protection which is required to protect our troops as well as the civilians in the border areas," he said.



PROSPECT

IREDA Q4 profit slips 1.7% to ₹492.63 crore



State-owned IREDA (Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency) has posted a marginal 1.77 per cent decline in net profit to ₹492.63 crore during the March quarter on account of higher expenses. The company had reported a net profit of ₹501.55 crore in the same quarter a year ago, the company said in an exchange filing on Friday.

During January-March, the company's total income rose to ₹2,181.28 crore from ₹crore in the fourth quarter of the preceding 2024-25 financial year.

Expenses increased to ₹1,562.14 crore from ₹1,285.91 crore in the last quarter of FY25.

For the entire FY26, IREDA posted a net profit of ₹1,874 crore, up from ₹1,698 crore in 2024-25. Annual income also rose to ₹8,338.89 crore from ₹6,755.69 crore in FY25. In a separate statement, the company said it has "posted the highest ever annual profit."

The Board of Directors recommended a final dividend of ₹0.75 per equity share for the financial year 2025-26, subject to approval of shareholders in the ensuing Annual General Meeting.

Military school alumni win top honours among passing-out NDA cadets



The three top medal winners of the 150th course of the National Defence Academy (NDA) share a common foundation: all are alumni of military schools and institutions known for nurturing future military leaders.

During the Passing Out Parade on Saturday, Rohit Kajla was awarded the President's Gold Medal, while the President's Silver and Bronze Medals were presented to Peeyush Rautela and Sahil Sharma, whose entry to NDA was itself a statement of perseverance, respectively.

Kajla said his father, a retired Havildar from the 3 Grenadiers Regiment, motivated him to pursue a career in the armed forces. "I hail from Jhajjar, Haryana. Inspired by my father to join the armed forces, I was enrolled in Rashtriya Military School, Bengaluru. The training at the school prepared me for a career in the military, and I cleared the NDA examination and the SSB (Services Selection Board) interview," he said.

BPTP launches Downtown 66 in Gurugram

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Gurugram

BPTP Limited, one of the National Capital Region's established real estate developer, has announced the launch of Downtown 66, a premium residential development in Sector 66, Gurugram, with a Gross Development Value (GDV) of approximately ₹2,500 crore.

The residential development comprises 504 luxury residences in 3 & 3.5 BHK configurations, with prices starting from ₹5.32 crore. The project is being developed with an estimated investment of approximately ₹1,200 crore.

Positioned within one of the city's prominent urban corridors, the project is inspired by global downtowns where residences are seamlessly connected to social spaces, lifestyle experiences, and commercial hubs within a cohesive, walkable ecosystem, according to a press release.

Rising to an approximate height of 150 metres along Golf Course Extension Road, Downtown 66 introduces a built form that integrates architecture with a layered living experience one that moves beyond conventional residential planning towards a more curated, immersive, experience-oriented format of urban living.

"A architecture and everyday living come together within a structured, walkable framework in Gurugram," said Vineet Nanda, Chief Business Officer, BPTP Limited.

Import duty cut to improve cotton supply: Textile Ministry

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The Centre's move to exempt all customs duties on cotton imports for five months till October 30 will ensure adequate availability of cotton for the textile industry, lower input costs and boost the competitiveness of Indian textiles, the Textile Ministry said on Saturday.

Industry bodies welcomed the decision, terming it a "much-needed relief" for the apparel sector.

"The measure is expected to augment the availability of cotton for the Indian textile and apparel sector and provide much-needed relief



to the entire value chain," the Apparel Export Promotion Council (APEC) stated. In a notification, the Finance Ministry said the import duty exemption will be effective

Multilateral exercise PRAGATI 2026 concludes



TONY DAS ■ Guwahati/Shillong

The maiden edition of Multilateral Exercise PRAGATI 2026 concluded successfully at Umroi Military Station, Meghalaya, with a comprehensive 72-hour validation exercise that showcased enhanced interoperability, mutual trust and collective readiness among participating armed forces.

The exercise brought together over 400 military personnel from 13 nations — India, Bhutan, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, the Maldives, Myanmar,

Nepal, the Philippines, the Seychelles, Sri Lanka and Vietnam — under the banner of Partnership of Regional Armies for Growth and Transformation in the Indian Ocean Region (PRAGATI).

The closing ceremony was attended by six Vice Chiefs and more than 40 senior military officials from participating nations. Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth, Vice Chief of the Army Staff, hosted the visiting dignitaries and engaged in bilateral interactions aimed at strengthening defence cooperation and military-to-military relations.

Conducted in semi-moun-

tainous and jungle terrain, the exercise focused on counter-terrorism operations and featured intensive training through lectures, demonstrations and practical exercises. Participants trained together in mixed teams, undertaking activities such as rock craft, ambush and counter-ambush drills, slithering, jungle lane shooting, room and bus intervention, IED detection and casualty evacuation.

A major highlight of the exercise was the camaraderie and soldierly bonding displayed by participants, who trained and operated together under challenging conditions, fostering mutual understanding, trust and professional cooperation.

As part of the exercise, the Indian Army, in collaboration with FICCI and the Army Design Bureau, organised a defence equipment display showcasing indigenous defence technologies and next-generation military equipment.

Delhi's future lies in balancing urban growth with sustainability: LG Sandhu

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Saturday said Delhi's future lies in balancing urban growth with sustainability, protecting ecological assets such as the Yamuna floodplains and green belts, and fostering greater citizen participation.

He outlined a long-term roadmap for transforming the national Capital into a model city under the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

Addressing an industry forum attended by corporate leaders from northern India, Sandhu called for a fundamental shift in Delhi's development model, saying the city must move beyond traditional "concrete expansion" and adopt an approach that integrates environmental protection, technological innovation and inclusive growth.

He emphasised that Delhi's future competitive-



ness would not be measured merely by its skyline or physical infrastructure but by its liveability, connectivity and environmental resilience.

"The future identity of global cities will be shaped by how effectively they balance development with environmental responsibility," Sandhu said, urging industry leaders to move beyond the role of service providers and become strategic partners in a collaborative governance ecosystem.

The lieutenant governor noted that Delhi's green

belts, biodiversity zones and the Yamuna floodplains should be viewed as integral to the Capital's future urban identity. He described them as the city's "legacy narratives" and said their preservation and restoration would be critical to ensuring sustainable growth.

Sandhu stated that the ongoing initiatives, including large-scale plantation drives, ecological restoration projects and the rejuvenation of public parks, reflect a transition towards urban planning that prioritises public

health, climate resilience and heat mitigation. A key pillar of the proposed "Viksit Dilli" framework, he said, is the restoration and protection of Delhi's ecological assets, including the Yamuna floodplains, ridge areas, green belts, water bodies and neighbourhood parks.

Highlighting efforts in this direction, Sandhu referred to the Jal Sanchay Abhiyan under which 101 water bodies across the city are being rejuvenated in the first phase. He said such initiatives represent a lasting shift away from a development model focused solely on physical expansion towards one centred on ecological balance.

A greener Capital, he said, is not only an environmental objective but also essential for addressing rising temperatures, improving climate resilience and enhancing public health, particularly for vulnerable sections of society.

CCPA slaps ₹7 lakh fine on Vajiram and Ravi for misleading UPSC success claims

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

The Central Consumer Protection Authority has imposed a penalty of ₹7 lakh on Vajiram and Ravi IAS Study Centre for publishing misleading advertisements, which claimed credit for candidates who cleared the UPSC Civil Services Examination 2023, most of whom had enrolled only in its free interview guidance programme.

The regulator found that a majority of candidates cited in the institute's advertisements had enrolled only in its free interview guidance programme (IGP), a short-duration course that begins only after candidates have already cleared Prelims and Mains on their own.

The institute had claimed on its official website, shortly after results were declared,



that "8 Rank Holders in the Top 10" and "37 Rank Holders in the Top 50" are from Vajiram & Ravi.

It had further asserted that "every year, more than 30 per cent of the officers selected through UPSC Civil Services Examination are students of Vajiram & Ravi," the regulator said in a statement.

The Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA), headed by Chief Commissioner Nidhi Khare and Commissioner Anupam

Mishra, found that 7 out of the 8 top-10 rankers cited in the advertisement, and 29 out of the 37 top-50 rankers, had enrolled only in the free IGP, a fact the institute had not disclosed.

The concealment was not limited to 2023. Data examined by the CCPA revealed a consistent pattern of non-disclosure across multiple years.

In 2021, 86.36 per cent of the institute's successful candidates had enrolled only in the IGP; in 2022, the figure

was 78.31 per cent; in 2023, it rose sharply to 97.56 per cent; and in 2024, it stood at 71.69 per cent. In none of these years was this information disclosed on the institute's official website.

The CCPA noted that the IGP is a short-duration programme that commences only after a candidate has independently cleared both the Preliminary and Mains stages of the UPSC CSE, two highly competitive stages at which the institute had no academic contribution whatsoever. By prominently featuring such candidates alongside advertisements for comprehensive paid coaching programmes, without any disclosure of the specific course opted for, the institute created a misleading impression that these candidates were products of its full-length coaching.

DRI seizes over 24 kg of narcotic drugs in Kerala

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Kochi

The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) has seized over 24 kg of narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances in Kerala and arrested five individuals, the officials said on Saturday.

The Kochi Unit of the DRI seized the contraband, including methaqualone, methamphetamine and hashish oil, at Kochi, Malappuram and Thiruvananthapuram under Operation Chakravayuh. They were intended for illicit distribution.

Five individuals, including key operatives involved in the trafficking networks, have been apprehended under the provisions of the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985.

The contraband was



detected in different modes of smuggling, including passenger baggage at the airport, concealment in courier consignment and outbound export cargo, the ministry added.

During the last financial year, DRI's Kochi Zonal Unit seized narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances valued at approximately Rs 70.76 crore in Kerala and arrested 21 persons in connection with various NDPS cases.

Bihar Govt suspends two IAS officers on corruption charges

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Patna

The Bihar Government on Saturday suspended two senior IAS officers on charges of corruption, following recommendations based on findings shared by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) and the Special Vigilance Unit (SVU), as per official orders.

According to separate orders issued by the General Administration Department (GAD), the suspended officers are Yogesh Kumar Sagar of the 2017 batch and Abhilasha Kumari Sharma of the 2014



batch. While Sagar is currently posted with the Social Welfare Department, Sharma is posted with the Rural Development Department.

The suspension orders stated that documents received from the ED through the SVU, along with evidence and recorded statements, indicated that the officers were allegedly involved in obtaining

undue monetary benefits through bribery, commissions and other favours.

Both officers have also been accused of receiving benefits from a contractor who was recently arrested by the SVU in connection with a corruption case. Officials said the ED had conducted an inquiry into the matter and subsequently communicated its findings to the SVU, recommending further action. The two officers have been placed under suspension with immediate effect under Rule 3(3) of the All India Services (Discipline and Appeal) Rules, 1969.

FROM THE WORLD

HUNGARY

Bus crash: One killed, 23 injured

A bus carrying young athletes to a competition in Hungary early on Saturday veered into the opposing lane and then collided with a tree, killing the driver and injuring nearly two dozen, police said.

The accident occurred near the town of Hird in southwestern Hungary at around 5.20 am local time, Baranya County Police said in a statement, adding that the cause of the accident had not yet been determined.

There were 28 people on the bus including 19 youth competitors from the aerobics division of the nearby Pecs Sports School, as well as three coaches, six parents and the driver.

The bus was taking the students to the second round of a competition in the capital Budapest, around 120 miles to the north, when the crash occurred. (AP)

COLOMBO

SL suspends top Buddhist monk

The powerful Buddhist clergy in Sri Lanka on Saturday stripped a senior monk facing charges of child abuse after weeks of relentless pressure. Pallegama Hemarathana, one of the most prominent Buddhist monks, was on May 14 ordered to be remanded after being arrested on May 9 following an investigation into a case of child sexual abuse.

The 71-year-old monk is accused of abusing a 15-year-old girl in the temple premises located in the north central capital of Anuradhapura.

He, however, spent time in hospital without being transferred to jail until May 22, when he was granted bail.

PUBLICATION NOTICE
IN THE SUPREME COURT OF INDIA
EXTRA-ORDINARY APPELLATE JURISDICTION
SPECIAL LEAVE PETITION (CIVIL)
No. 35598 OF 2025
VIRENDER SINGH (Petitioner(s)/Appellant(s))
VERSUS
GOVIND RAM AGGARWAL AND OTHERS... Respondent(s)

To,
1. MR. NISCHAL KUMAR NEERAJ (adv.),
47 Law Chambers, Supreme Court Compound, New Delhi.
2. MR. PRAVIR CHOUDHARY (adv.),
3. Ms. Goldy Goyal (adv.),
10, Ground Floor Vinobapuri Lajpat Nagar-II - 110024.
*Please find enclosed herewith Publication Notice to serve upon respondents and file in this Registry proof of publication alongwith affidavit well before next date of hearing.

ASSISTANT REGISTRAR
LEGAL AID
(1) Legal Services of an advocate is provided by the Supreme Court Legal Services Committee and the Supreme Court Middle Income Group Legal Aid Society to eligible litigants.
For further information, please contact the Secretary, Supreme Court Legal Services Committee or the Member Secretary, Supreme Court Middle Income Group Legal Aid Society, 107, Lawyers' Chambers, R.K. Jain Block - Near Post Office, Supreme Court Compound, Tilak Marg, New Delhi-110001 (Tel Nos. 011-23116353, 23116354 (Additional Building Complex) and 011-23381257 (Front Office)).
MEDIATION
(2) The facility of amicable settlement of disputes by trained mediators in cases pending in the Supreme Court is now available in the Supreme Court.
For further information, please contact the Coordinators, Supreme Court Legal Services Committee, 107, Lawyers' Chambers, R.K. Jain Block - Near Post Office, Supreme Court Compound, Tilak Marg, New Delhi-110001 (Tel No. 011-23071432).

Soldiers report Gaza killings despite ceasefire

SAM MEDNICK ■ Tel Aviv

The Israeli combat soldier saw his teammates yelling in celebration, congratulating one another. They had just struck a vehicle of Palestinians driving near the Israeli-controlled part of the Gaza Strip, killing everyone inside.

The reservist said scenes like this had become common after a fragile ceasefire took effect in October. In the weeks he was stationed in Gaza, he said, he saw soldiers relishing the chance to go after those who crossed — or came close to crossing — the so-called yellow line that divides the strip into Israeli-controlled and Palestinian areas.

"It was a jungle," the soldier, in his 20s, told The

Associated Press. "After the ceasefire, the order was: If someone crosses the line, you shoot them."

As diplomatic efforts to strengthen the deal have stalled, three soldiers described to AP a sense of confusion in the embattled territory, with a lack of clarity on rules of engagement around the yellow line. Some commanders paid lip service to the agreement, the soldiers said, while privately voicing desire for the war in Gaza to continue. Sometimes, troops were too far away or acted too quickly to recognize who they were shooting, one soldier said — a concern echoed in comments from a whistleblower group of veterans.

The soldiers' accounts are



a rare glimpse into what's happened in the Israeli-controlled part of Gaza since the deal went into effect seven months ago. The soldiers — reservists deployed throughout Gaza between October

and January who've since returned — spoke on condition of anonymity because they feared being ostracized over their comments.

They said they were speaking out because they were

angered and saddened by what they saw.

AP has documented shootings of Palestinian civilians, including children playing, close to the yellow line. And the soldiers said it felt like the killings never stopped amid the tenuous deal.

"To call it a ceasefire is a joke," one soldier told AP.

Gaza's yellow line has been ambiguous, and Israel has taken control of more land.

When the ceasefire went into effect, Israel withdrew troops to a buffer zone demarcated by a yellow line, giving it control of just over half the strip. Under the agreement, Israeli forces are meant to complete a fuller withdrawal, though there's no timeline for that. The US-backed diplomat overseeing

the truce says progress is deadlocked over the central sticking point of disarming Hamas, upon which all other issues — including Israeli withdrawals and reconstruction — hinge. In the meantime, Israel has expanded control over additional territory in Gaza. Both sides have accused the other of violating the ceasefire.

The line's exact location has been ambiguous and sometimes invisible. In some places, it's marked with yellow blocks and barrels; in others, it at times hasn't been indicated at all.

The Israeli military invited AP this week to see a section of the yellow line in central Gaza, near the Maghazi refugee camp. The line there was visible, demarcated by a

wide dirt path and small yellow markings. To the east was a desolate stretch of open space leading to a heavily fortified Israeli military post about 500 meters away.

An Israeli military commander said Hamas is active on the other side of the line and frequently sends people — militants and civilians — toward the line and even across it to test the army's readiness and responses.

"There is no reason for anyone to come near the line," he said, speaking on condition of anonymity under military rules. "There's nothing here."

The army says the entire line, which stretches the length of Gaza, is now clearly marked. (AP)

India, EAEU discuss limited interim trade deal: Russian minister

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Moscow

India and the Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) are discussing a "limited and temporary" trade arrangement covering selected groups of goods as part of negotiations on a proposed free trade agreement, Russia's Economic Development Minister Maxim Reshetnikov has said, according to a media report.



Russia's Economic Development Minister Maxim Reshetnikov

Describing the negotiations as "complex", Reshetnikov said on Friday that the Indian side's requests were "quite ambitious". "Things are more complicated with India: the economy is larger, mutual interests are more complex, so to speak. And, frankly, our colleagues' requests are also quite ambitious," he said in an interview with the Vesti programme, according to the state-run TASS news agency.

"Therefore, we are currently discussing a limited and temporary free trade zone, that is, for a list of goods defined by product groups," he added.

Reshetnikov's remarks came hours after Russian President Vladimir Putin said negotiations on trade liberalisation between India and the EAEU had gained momentum. Speaking at a meeting of the Supreme Eurasian Economic Council in Kazakhstan's capital Astana, Putin was quoted as saying by TASS: "Last year trade agreements were concluded with Mongolia and the United Arab Emirates, as

well as with Indonesia, intensifying negotiations on trade liberalisation with India."

The Russian president added that the EAEU supported launching talks on free trade agreements with new partners and that all aspects of such cooperation would be carefully analysed.

The EAEU is a five-member economic bloc comprising Russia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Armenia.

It was established in 2015 to promote economic integration through a common market, removal of trade barriers and coordination of economic policies among member states.

The India-EAEU free trade agreement process has gathered momentum in recent years. In August 2025, India and the EAEU signed the Terms of Reference to formally launch negotiations for a free trade agreement. At the time, the two sides said bilateral trade turnover had reached USD 69 billion in 2024, up seven per cent from the previous year.

The first round of negotiations was held in November last year.

Truck carrying refugees crashes in eastern Afghanistan, killing 22

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kabul

A truck carrying Afghan refugees returning from neighbouring Pakistan overturned on a highway in eastern Afghanistan on Saturday, killing at least 22 people and injuring about 36 others, most of them women and children, officials said.

The accident occurred in Laghman province on the main highway linking Kabul, the Afghan capital, with Nangarhar province, said Abdul Malik Niaza, the spokesperson for the provincial governor.

He said among the dead were 10 children and five women, and the injured were taken to hospitals in Nangarhar.

The provincial director of public health, Aminullah Sharif, said 22



people were killed and about 36 injured. He said the accident occurred when the truck fell into a ditch after the driver fell asleep.

The passengers were among thousands of Afghans who recently returned from Pakistan, which launched a crackdown on migrants

WHO head visits Congo's Bunia amid fast-spreading Ebola outbreak

JUSTIN KABUMBA/MARK BANCHEREAU ■ Bunia (Congo)

The head of the World Health Organisation Saturday arrived in eastern Congo's Bunia, a city at the heart of an outbreak of a rare type of Ebola, where the virus still spreads faster than the response, despite better-organised health facilities and new aid arrivals.

WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus is expected to visit a treatment centre and meet local authorities, health workers and affected families in Bunia.

"The best way to address this is to provide all the necessary support to fight the disease at its epicentre and to continue offering every assistance needed," Tedros told reporters late Friday.

The WHO said Friday authorities have reported 906 suspected cases and 223 suspected deaths.



Neighbouring Uganda has confirmed nine cases and one death, the Ugandan min-

istry of health said Friday. The Bundibugyo virus, the current kind of Ebola, has no

approved treatment or vaccine. "This is a difficult situation, and we recognise

that. But the Democratic Republic of Congo has faced the Ebola virus many times before. We are confident that it can once again bring this outbreak under control," Tedros told reporters Friday after meeting with Congo's Prime Minister Judith Suminwa Tuluka.

Medical aid donated by the European Union arrived in Ituri, the heart of Congo's Ebola outbreak, on Thursday, with more shipments expected over the next eight days.

The US announced \$80 million in additional aid on the same day, bringing its total commitment to more than \$112 million.

Response efforts at Bunia's Rwampara and General hospitals appear more organised, with additional staff, protective gear and medical supplies, though patients continue arriving around the clock, an AP reporter observed on Friday. (AP)

HINDUSTAN AUTO FINANCE LIMITED				
CIN:L65910DL1980PLC010617				
E-mail: hindaf1980@gmail.com, Website: www.hindaf.in				
Regd. Off: Cabin No. DA-8, 02 nd Floor, Vikas Marg, Shakarpur, New Delhi-110092				
Extract of Unaudited Financial results for the Quarter and Financial year ended 31st March, 2026				
(₹ in Lakhs)				
SL. No.	Particulars	Quarter ended 31.03.2026	Year ended 31.03.2026	Quarter ended 31.03.2025
		Audited	Audited	Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	1.32	1.32	0.10
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	12.13	1.42	14.86
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	12.13	1.42	14.86
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	12.13	1.42	14.86
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	12.13	1.42	14.86
6	Equity Share Capital	35.03	35.03	35.03
7	Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet as on 31.03.2026	-	-102.05	-
8	Earning per share			
	1. Basic	0.35	0.04	0.42
	2. Diluted	0.35	0.04	0.42
Notes:				
(1) The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange and the listed entity. (https://www.hindaf.in/investor-deck/financial-statements/)				
(2) The above audited Financial Results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 were reviewed by the Audit Committee and thereafter approved and taken on record by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 30th May, 2026. The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out an audit of the above financial results and they have issued an unqualified report.				
For M/s Hindustan Auto Finance Limited				
Sd/-				
Subhash Sapra				
Managing Director				
DIN:00241940				
Date: 30.05.2026				
Place: New Delhi				

PRAKASH WOOLLEN & SYNTHETIC MILLS LIMITED					
Regd. office: 18th KM Stone, Delhi Moradabad Road, NH24, Village-Amhera, Distt: J.P.NAGAR-244102, U.P.					
CIN:L7291UP1979PLC004804					
PH: 9760091983, Email:info@prakashwoollen.com, Website: www.prakashwoollen.com					
Extract of Audited Financial Results (Standalone) for the Quarter and Year Ended 31/03/2026					
Particulars	Quarter ended		Year Ended		
	31-Mar-26	31-Dec-25	31-Mar-25	31-Mar-26	31-Mar-25
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	Audited
Total income from operations (net)	1194.38	5109.43	597.26	10631.80	10519.40
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	49.56	(16.35)	(326.28)	(105.80)	(909.13)
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	49.56	(16.35)	727.55	(57.98)	144.70
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	144.52	(186.40)	752.44	(88.77)	125.65
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	118.21	(186.40)	808.38	(115.08)	181.59
Equity Share Capital	1025.98	1025.98	1025.98	1025.98	1025.98
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Balance Sheet of previous year)	-	-	-	-	-
Earnings per share (before extraordinary items) (of Rs. 10/-each):					
(a) Basic	1.41	(1.82)	7.33	(0.86)	1.22
(b) Diluted	1.41	(1.82)	7.33	(0.86)	1.22
Earnings per share (after extraordinary items) (of Rs. 10/-each):					
(a) Basic	1.41	(1.82)	7.33	(0.86)	1.22
(b) Diluted	1.41	(1.82)	7.33	(0.86)	1.22
Notes:					
1. The above results were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on 30th May 2026.					
2. This statement has been prepared in accordance with the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 (Ind AS) prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standard) Rules 2015 and Companies (Indian Accounting Standard) (Amendment) Rules, 2016.					
3. The figures for the quarter ended 31.03.2026 and 31.03.2025 are the balancing figures between audited figures in respect of the full financial year and those published till the third quarter of the respective financial year.					
4. The above results have been audited by statutory auditors, and they have issued unmodified opinion on above audited results.					
5. The company is engaged in the made ups of textile business, therefore, there is only one reportable segment in accordance with the Accounting Standards on Segment Reporting (Ind AS 108).					
6. The made ups of textiles (blankets etc.) business is seasonal in nature and accordingly financial results for the quarter are not representative of the whole year.					
7. Details of Exceptional Items of Rs 47.82 and Rs 1053.83 Lakh are as under:					
Profit on Sale of Land & Building: Rs 40.33 Rs 992.97 Lakh					
Write back of Revaluation Reserve: Rs 7.49 Rs 60.86 Lakh					
Total Rs.47.82 Rs.1053.83 Lakh					
8. During the current reporting period, the company has received the following government assistance:					
a. A grant of Rs 270.98 lakh as capital subsidy was received towards the acquisition of specific machines for expansion of production capacity. This amount has been deducted to arrive at the carrying amount of the respective machines.					
b. A grant of Rs 114.10 lakh was received as re-imbursement for interest cost incurred on Term Loan. This amount has been deducted from the 'Finance cost' presented in the statement of results.					
9. Previous year/ quarter figures have been regrouped wherever required.					
By Order Of The Board					
For Prakash Woollen & Synthetic Mills Limited					
Vijay Kumar Gupta					
Whole Time Director & CFO					
DIN: 00353325					

The Pioneer

Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Pradeep Kumar, S/o Sh. Sohnapal, R/o H. No. 122, Jaitpur Gaon, Badarpur Jaitpur, South Delhi, Delhi-110044, have changed my minor daughter's name from Harshita alias Harshita Kardam aged 12 years to Harshita Kardam for all future purposes.

PD(1218)C

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Mrs. Raj Balu was the owner of Second floor without roof rights (Block-D floor) built up on property no. D-23 (Plot no. 23, Block-D), area measuring 90 Sq. Yds i.e. 75.24 Sq. Mtrs (Plinth covered area measuring 75 Sq. Mtrs), Out of Kharsa no. 779484 situated at Village Sikdar Pur in the abadi of Block-D, East Jyoti Nagar, Loni Road, Ilaga Shikhar, Delhi-110023 through sale Deed dated 30.05.2013 executed by Mrs. Premila Singh in favour of Mrs. Raj Balu in respect of second floor without roof rights built up on property no. D-23 (Plot no. 23, Block-D), area measuring 90 Sq. Yds i.e. 75.24 Sq. Mtrs (Plinth covered area measuring 75 Sq. Mtrs), Out of Kharsa no. 779484. Unfortunately, Mrs. Raj Balu died on dated 16.11.2014 & Her Husband Mr. Brij Pal had also died on dated 13.02.2015 leaving behind their legal heirs namely (1) Jitender Kumar (Son), Sonika Malik (Daughter), Renuka Tonia (Daughter). Thereafter, Relinquishment Deed dated 17.06.2015 executed by Mrs. Renuka Tonia in favour of Mrs. Sonika Malik in respect of release her covered area measuring 75 Sq. Mtrs, Out of Kharsa no. 779484 and Relinquishment Deed dated 07.08.2019 executed by Mr. Jitender Kumar in favour of Mrs. Sonika Malik in respect of release her share of second floor without roof rights built up on property no. D-23 (Plot no. 23, Block-D), area measuring 90 Sq. Yds i.e. 75.24 Sq. Mtrs. (Plinth covered area measuring 75 Sq. Mtrs.), Out of Kharsa no. 779484.

Mrs. Sonika Malik intends to transfer the ownership of above said property by way of Sale Deed to Mr. Deepak Kumar. Subsequently, Mr. Deepak Kumar is in the process of mortgaging the said property with SBI India Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7-day period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-day period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@northn

BRIEFLY

Ramesh, Srikanth shine in surfing competition



Kerala's Ramesh Budihal topped the standings with an impressive score of 14.83, while Srikanth D followed closely with 13.00 in the men's open quarterfinals of the seventh NMPA Indian Open of Surfing 2026 here on Saturday.

Teenage sensation Kishore Kumar (11.80), Ajeesh Ali (9.93), Sanjay Selvamani (9.57) and Sivaraj Babu (8.76) also secured their places in the semifinals after strong performances across the heats.

The second day of the tournament, a crucial stop on the national surfing series and a significant event in the selection of the Indian team for the 2026 Asian Games, greeted competitors with cool breezes and clear, sunny skies.

A total of six quarterfinals and six semifinals were contested across five different categories.

(PTI)

Asian U20 Championships: India wins 3 gold on day 3



Indian athletes clinched three gold medals to continue their strong performance and retain the second spot at the end of the third and penultimate day of the Asian U20 Championships here on Saturday.

Nikhil Chandrashekar (3000m steeplechase), Basant (high jump) and Shahnavaz Khan (long jump) swelled the Indian gold medal tally to seven. India had won four gold medals on Friday. Nikhil Chandrashekar sprinted to victory in the men's 3000m steeplechase. His winning time of 9:25.44 seconds was his personal best.

Shahnavaz Khan won the second gold medal as he dominated the men's long jump. His best jump of the day was 7.84m. Compatriot Jithin Arjunan Raman Chandrasekaran won silver with a jump of 7.66m.

(PTI)

Robinson learns of World Cup berth on golf course

RONALD BLUM
■ Fayetteville (North Carolina, USA)

Antonee Robinson got the news on the 13th hole of a golf course in the English countryside, Gio Reyna in a Connecticut parking lot while enjoying a smoothie alongside his wife and dog.

Cristian Roldan tucked a phone into his pocket during a Seattle Sounders team meeting.

"I just wanted it to feel and vibrate," he said.

American players dispersed across North America and Europe were told notification of coach Mauricio Pochettino's World Cup picks would arrive via WhatsApp at

1 pm EDT on May 22.

Chris Brady, hoping to earn the number 3 goalkeeper spot, was in the Central time zone and waited nervously with Chicago Fire teammates.

"When 12 struck, nothing came... what does that mean?" he remembered thinking. "But, yeah, eventually got the message."

Gathered now at the new US National Soccer Training Center and a nearby hotel in Trilith ahead of their June 12 World Cup opener against Paraguay, players relaxed after making the cut for their sport's pinnacle event.

"It was just sheer elation," 27-year-old defender Mark McKenzie said. "Four years of hard work, sacrifice. It was



obviously heartbreaking not making '22 but turned it directly into just motivation to make sure the next time around my name would hopefully be on that roster."

In the rush to get to the US, McKenzie left his film camera

back in France, where he plays for Toulouse.

Robinson, still the first-choice left back at age 28 after starting four years ago, hadn't allowed himself to think too far ahead during a season in which a difficult recovery

Mexico president gifts her World Cup ticket to Indigenous athlete

FABIOLA SANCHEZ
■ Mexico City

Mexico President Claudia Sheinbaum delivered a promise on Friday by giving away her ticket to the World Cup opening match.

Sheinbaum, the first female president in the country's 200-year history, donated her ticket number 00001 to Yolett Cervantes Cuaquehua, a 21-year-old Indigenous woman from the eastern state of Veracruz.

Mexico plays the opening match against South Africa on June 11 at Azteca Stadium.

Cervantes Cuaquehua was selected by a jury after winning a contest for her ball-handling skills.

"They are the pride of Mexico. They will not repre-



sent the president, or the head of government, they will represent Mexico," Sheinbaum said at a press conference to give away the ticket to Cervantes Cuaquehua. Sheinbaum also gave away tickets to other matches being played in Mexico City, Guadalajara,

and Monterrey - the Mexican venues for the World Cup - to three other amateur athletes aged 16, 22, and 23.

They were also selected by the jury as part of a contest organized by the government.

"Thank you so much for considering us," Cervantes

Cuaquehua said. Sheinbaum in March ruled out attending the opening game, stating she wanted to give prominence to young Mexican female soccer players.

"I think a young woman who plays soccer is a great representative of our country. Very few people will be able to attend the opening," Sheinbaum said at the time. She added she will watch the game at the Zocalo, the capital's main square, where a Fan Fest will be set up.

The president's announcement generated mixed reactions in Mexico. While some considered it a commendable decision, others criticized it, arguing that it was a missed opportunity to promote the country.

Nice beat Saint-Etienne to retain Ligue 1 spot



ASSOCIATED PRESS
■ Nice (France)

Nice stayed in Ligue 1 after beating Saint-Etienne 4-1 in the second leg of their promotion-relegation playoff on Friday.

All of the goals came in the second half with striker Elye Wahi sealing the victory with

two late goals. French Cup runner-up Nice finished 16th in Ligue 1 and Saint-Etienne placed third in Ligue 2.

The first leg finished 0-0 on Tuesday and the return leg was played behind closed doors after crowd trouble marred Nice's final league game.

Davies named to Canada's World Cup squad despite hamstringing injury

ANNE M PETERSON
■ Montreal

Alphonso Davies was named to Canada's World Cup squad on Friday night although it's too soon to tell whether he'll be ready for the team's opener because of a hamstringing injury. The defender, who plays for Bayern Munich, was injured earlier this month in the loss to Paris Saint-Germain in the Champions League semifinals.

Davies is Canada's captain and among the most prominent players named to the team, along with Juventus forward Jonathan David, Southampton forward Cyle Larin and Villarreal midfielder Tajon Buchanan.

Coach Jesse Marsch named nine defenders, 10 midfielders, four forwards and three goalkeepers to the 26-player roster for the World Cup, which opens on June 11.

Marsch included Davies on the team's latest 32-player training camp roster earlier this week, but he did not immediately join the team, instead remaining in Germany to continue his recovery. The team trained this past week in Charlotte, North Carolina, ahead of a pair of preparation matches against Uzbekistan on Monday in Edmonton and against Ireland on June 5 in Montreal. "He (Davies) is already on the pitch running, and so we've got to just kind of see where he's at in his overall progres-

sion, and then we've got to try to find ways to accelerate him, but he's super excited to get here," Marsch said. "I'm really hopeful that he has a few days to get away, and that he can come here and be fresh."

Canada is co-hosting the World Cup with the United States and Mexico. The Canadians are in Group B along with Switzerland, Qatar and Bosnia and Herzegovina, which eliminated Italy in the European playoffs.

The Canadians will have all three of their group-stage matches on home soil. Ranked number 30 in the world, Canada opens against Bosnia and Herzegovina on June 12 in Toronto. Earlier this week Marsch suggested Davies may not quite be ready for the opener. Canada has been to the World Cup twice before, in Mexico 1986 and 2022, but the team has never advanced past the group stage. The team finished at



the bottom of its group in Qatar four years ago, but Davies scored the nation's first World Cup goal in a 4-1 loss to Croatia.

Other players coming off injuries with their club teams included forward Promise David, who just had hip surgery for a ruptured tendon in February, and defender Moise Bombito, who has not played for the national team since breaking his leg in a 2-2 draw with Monaco in October.

who can we project to be really ready to be close to 100 per cent and in the form of their life going into this tournament. So, luckily, we're on track with a lot of guys," Marsch said.

"Will everyone be 100 per cent for the Bosnia match? No, that won't be the case, but we will have a really strong core that will be ready for that match, and we believe we can get stronger as the tournament goes on."

Marsch has not named a starter between goalkeepers Maxime Crepeau and Dayne St. Clair. Both will play in the upcoming friendlies before Marsch makes a decision. "We know what's coming in terms of a decision and we're both mature enough to understand our role for the team, whatever the decision is," Crepeau said on the Canadian television broadcast announcing the squad. "We understand that we'll be here for one another and for the team on and off the field."

SUPERIOR FINLEASE LIMITED					
CIN: LT4899DL1994PLC061995					
Regd. Off: at NS-92,Khasra No – 33/21,Ranaji Enclave, Najafgarh, Near Arjun park Bus Stand New Delhi – 110043					
Email id: superiorfinlease@gmail.com; Website: www.superiorfinlease.com					
Extract of Statement of Audited Financial Result for the Quarter and Year Ended 31st March 2026					
Sl No.	Particulars	Quarter ended for			Year Ended for
		01.01.2026 to 31.03.2026 (Rs."lacs") Audited	01.10.2025 to 31.12.2025 (Rs."lacs") Unaudited	01.01.2025 to 31.03.2025 (Rs."lacs") Audited	31.03.2025 to 31.03.2025 (Rs."lacs") Audited
1	Total Revenue from Operations	11.02	7.99	10.31	34.47
2	Profit / (loss) before exceptional items and tax (III-IV)	1.86	3.24	-7.81	5.85
3	Profit/(loss) before tax (V-VI)	1.86	3.24	-7.81	5.85
4	Profit / (loss) for the period from continuing operations (VII-VIII)	1.81	3.24	-7.81	4.77
5	Total Comprehensive income for the period (XIII + XV)	1.81	3.24	-7.81	4.77
6	Paid up equity share capital (Face value Rs. 1/- per share)	510.81	432.60	432.60	510.81
7	Reserve excluding Revaluation Reserves as per balance sheet of previous accounting year	89.58	84.81	84.81	89.58
8	Earnings per equity share (1) Basic (In Rupees)	0.00	0.01	-0.02	0.01
	(2) Diluted (In Rupees)	0.00	0.01	-0.02	0.01
Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly and year ended Financial Results filed with the stock exchange under regulation 33of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the said Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange Website i.e. www.mseil.in and www.bseindia.com and company's website i.e. www.superiorfinlease.com.					
SUPERIOR FINLEASE LIMITED					
Date: 31.05.2026					
Place: Delhi					
Rajneesh Kumar Director DIN:02463693					

Council of Architecture
Ministry of Education, Government of India.

NATA 2026

CHOOSE ARCHITECTURE

बनें राष्ट्र निर्माण के भागीदार

IMPORTANT PUBLIC NOTICE

CONDUCT OF NATA 2026 FOR ADMISSION TO B.ARCH. COURSE

The Council of Architecture is conducting the National Aptitude Test in Architecture (NATA) 2026 for admission to the First Year of the 5-Year B.Arch. Degree Programme. Registration for NATA 2026 Phase-1 is currently open and will close on **09.06.2026. The last examination under Phase-1 is scheduled to be held on 13.06.2026.**

The scores obtained in Phase-1 shall be considered for admission to B.Arch. programmes through the Centralized Admission Process (CAP) Counselling conducted by various admission authorities across States and Union Territories. **Candidates aspiring to pursue the B.Arch. Degree Programme are advised to complete their registration for NATA 2026 at the earliest, well before the closing date.**

WHO CAN APPLY?

12TH PASSED OR APPEARED STUDENTS WITH PHYSICS AND MATHEMATICS AS COMPULSORY SUBJECTS ALONG WITH EITHER CHEMISTRY OR BIOLOGY OR TECHNICAL VOCATIONAL SUBJECT OR COMPUTER SCIENCE OR INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY OR INFORMATICS PRACTICES OR ENGINEERING GRAPHICS OR BUSINESS STUDIES OR DIPLOMA STUDENTS WITH MATHEMATICS, SCORING ATLEAST 45% AGGREGATE, IN EACH CASE.

The NATA 2026 brochure containing eligibility criteria, syllabus and list of institutions admitting students to B.Arch. programme based on NATA score along with other important details is available on **www.nata.in** and **www.coa.gov.in**.

A candidate may appear in a maximum of two attempts. NATA 2026 score shall be valid for 2026-2027 academic year only.

New Delhi
Date : 31.05.2026

Registrar

HIMALAYA FOOD INTERNATIONAL LIMITED					
Regd. Office: 118, 1st Floor, 12 Gagandeep Building, Rajendra Place, New Delhi-110008					
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website: www.himalayafoodcompany.com					
EXTRACT OF AUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31ST, 2026					
S. No.	Particulars	(Rs. In Lakhs)			
		Yearly	Quarter Ended		Year ended
		31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.12.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	3958	844	995	880
2.	Net Profit for the period (before tax & exceptional items)	293	-316	78	40
3.	Net Profit for the period before Tax (after exceptional items)	293	-316	78	40
4.	Net Profit for the period after Tax (after exceptional items)	370	-239	78	114
5.	Total Comprehensive income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	370	-239	78	114
6.	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Rs. 10/- per share)	8479	8479	5787	8479
7.	Earnings Per Share i) Basic In Rs. ii) Diluted In Rs.	0.44 0.44	-0.28 -0.28	0.13 0.13	0.13 0.13
Notes:					
1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Audited Financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31st, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the aforesaid Audited Financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31st, 2026 are available on BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and the Company website (www.himalayafoodcompany.com).					
2. The financial results have been prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standard (Ind AS) prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 as amended from time to time.					
For and on behalf of the Board					
Sd/-					
Man Mohan Malik					
Managing Director					
(DIN: 00696077)					
Date: 30.05.2026					
Place: New Delhi					

India lose 2-3 to Australia, share women's hockey series 2-2



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Perth

The Indian women's hockey team lost 2-3 against hosts Australia to share the four-match friendly series 2-2 here on Saturday.

India came out strongly in the contest, taking a 1-0 lead in just the second minute when Navneet Kaur converted a penalty corner to put early pressure on Australia.

In the second quarter, Deepika Soreng (23th) doubled India's lead with a neat conversion. It remained 2-0 at half-time.

Australia fought back in the third quarter, levelling through strikes from Abby Wilson (42nd) and Olivia Downes (44th) in quick succession. A late strike from Courtney Schonell (58th) gave the hosts a narrow 3-2 win.

Despite the result, India can take plenty of positives from the tour.

Having bounced back from an opening-game defeat to win the next two matches, the Indian team demonstrated resilience, tactical discipline and a potent attacking threat throughout the series, continuing to build ahead of the upcoming season that begins with the FIH Nations Cup in New Zealand.

India had lost 1-2 against Australia in the series opener but bounced back strongly to beat the hosts 4-2 in shootout after both the sides were locked 1-1 at the end of regulation time in the second match. India then defeated Australia in the third match to take a 2-1 lead in the series.

The Indians have impressed in most aspects of the game in the tour so far, especially in defence and midfield. The tour Down Under served as important preparation ahead of the Women's Nations Cup in Auckland from June 15-21.

Vinesh Phogat loses in semifinals at Asian Games trials

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ New Delhi

Vinesh Phogat was knocked out of the Asian Games selection trials here on Saturday after losing to Meenakshi Goyat 4-6 in a tense semifinal bout of the women's 53kg event. The loss will dash Vinesh's hopes of a comeback and her chances of securing a berth at the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan later this year.

Earlier, Vinesh had summoned her years of experience to prevail in a fiercely fought bout against a super aggressive Nishu to reach the semifinals.

After a rather easy 7-1 win against Jyoti, Vinesh had to contend with a technically

sound Nishu, who opened up a massive 5-0 lead and almost pinned the star grappler in the first period after a sensational four-point throw, but she survived.

The bout was emotionally charged but was littered with challenges and technical fail- ures of the screens. The res- ultant long breaks gave Vinesh much needed breather. She remains technically skilled, but time away from the mat has certainly taken a toll on her endurance.

Nishu used the half head locks effectively to keep Vinesh under check for a large part but Vinesh needed that one move to turn the tables and she found that in the second period — a pow-

erful four-pointer as she threw Nishu on mat. Vinesh had Nishu in her grip as she went for a pin.

Sitting in her coach corner, her husband Sombir Rathi and supporters charged on the net, demanding a pin. Eventually, a challenge was sought. It was ruled that the referee gave 'wrong whistle' but Vinesh was not given the 'pin' result. Nishu was put on the ground position, though she could not take advantage. Another two- pointer put Vinesh ahead 6- 5. It soon became 6-6, putting Vinesh ahead on criteria. Nishu attempted a take down but was not given points. Nishu's coach challenged the decision but lost as Vinesh left



the mat relieved. Stunned, Nishu refused to share hands with the referee and Vinesh and stood on mat for a long time, crying. She will now fight it out with Meenakshi Goyat, who had shocked

Antim Pangal in the Asian Championship trials. Meanwhile, Antim Panghal needed only 34 seconds to make a winning start as she defeated Tannu by technical superiority.

I HAVE NOT FAILED, SAYS VINESH AFTER EXITING ASIAN GAMES TRIALS

New Delhi: Vinesh Phogat asserted on Saturday that she has “not failed” after exiting the Asian Games selection trials with a semifinal defeat to Meenakshi Goyat, vowing to come back stronger. Vinesh was knocked out of the trials after losing to Meenakshi 4-6 in a tense semifinal bout of the women's 53kg event.

“I have not failed,” were Vinesh's first words after the defeat here.

“I was fighting a whole system, I was on one side and everyone else on the other,” Vinesh added, referring to her longstanding battle with the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI).

She was allowed to compete in the trials by the Supreme Court after a favourable decision from the Delhi High Court also. “I had to fight for every point, I was not given a fair deal.”

Vinesh also vowed to come back, saying she will keep preparing, but did not specify where she would compete next.

Earlier in the day, two-time world championships medallist Vinesh was allowed to compete in the women's 53kg category after the WFI reversed its earlier stand of restricting her participation to the 50kg division.

The dramatic turn of events came during the official weigh-in on Saturday morning when Vinesh was informed that she would be permitted to compete only in the 50kg category, citing her participation in that weight class in her last four international events, including the Paris Olympics.

The wrestler strongly objected to the decision and accused the federation of discriminating against her by denying her the opportunity to compete in a category of her choice.

Sangakkara questions Sam Curran’s absence from IPL



BHARAT SHARMA
■ Mullanpur

Rajasthan Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara has questioned the last-minute injury pull-out from England all-rounder Sam Curran and said the BCCI must continue to ensure that foreign players meet their contractual obligations throughout the Indian Premier League.

Curran had withdrawn from the IPL citing a season-ending groin injury. However, he is back in action having played three games for Surrey in the T20 Blast back home.

Overseas players' availability has always been an issue in the IPL. This season, Mitchell Starc and Pat Cummins turned up for their respective teams in the second half of the competi- tion due to niggles.

Punjab Kings co-owner Mohit Burman too has said the BCCI and foreign boards need to align better on player availability so that a team's balance is not impacted signif- icantly. The BCCI already has a two-year ban in place for a foreign player who pulls out of the IPL after being bought in the auction.

Following the loss to

Gujarat Titans in the Eliminator, the Royals' coach Sangakkara expressed his frustration over Curran's case that forced them to find a replacement in Dasun Shanaka. “We were told that Sam Curran had a season- ending injury, but I think I saw him playing for Surrey for two games or three games now, so that was disappoint- ing.” “We'd have loved to have had him here playing for us, but I think having got Dasun Shanaka as a replacement when we were told early, everyone should be extreme- ly proud of themselves,” said Sangakkara.

Can the BCCI deal with the player availability problem more strictly?

“A proper tight policy around that is always a requirement. The BCCI has a strict policy on that. Every person goes through injuries, and if it's a serious injury, (or) a season-ending injury, of course we understand,” said the head coach.

“We've had quite a few injuries. We've also had players like Adam Milne, (Shimron) Hetmyer, quite a few who've come here, not had much of a game. Lthuan-dre Pretorius is another one.” (PTI)

Shubman Gill: Not playing to the occasion brings out best in Gujarat Titans

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Mullanpur

A ton-up Shubman Gill on Friday said not playing to the occasion brings out the best in Gujarat Titans as his side qualified for the final of IPL 2026 with a commanding seven-wicket win over Rajasthan Royals here.

Gill smacked 104 off 53 balls with 15 fours and three sixes to eclipse the first- innings heroics of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who made a calculated 96, to power Gujarat Titans' victory in the Qualifier 2 here.

“(The) feeling is really good. But (a) quick turn- around so tomorrow (Saturday) we'll just rest and recover and then go there

and assess conditions,” Gill told the broadcaster after the match here.

“If you don't play the occa- sion it brings the best out of us and that's what we spoke about. Let's take the occasion out and play some good cricket. Whether we win or lose, we should play good cricket,” he said while reveal- ing GT's mantra.

The IPL final this year will be a repeat of the Qualifier 1 in which defending champi- ons Royal Challengers Bengaluru had beaten Gujarat Titans by 92 runs.

GT's win on Friday was built on a 167-run opening stand between Gill and Sai Sudharsan (58), who was dis- missed hit-wicket for a second game in a row. “We



complement each other and each other's game very well. When we are batting out there our communication is very good. One of us has to take down one of the bowlers and we are very good in deciding which

Gill said he wanted to finish the game for the Titans.

“I was in the kind of zone where I was just looking at the gaps and the bowler and see my zone and try to hit it there. That's what happens when you're batting well, you see the gaps and middle it,” Gill said.

“At one point we thought we could restrict them to 180-190 but they made 210 (214/6) so we just wanted to get a good start. I wanted to finish it off but got out,” he said.

Rajasthan Royals' skipper Riyan Parag said a score of around 240 would have been challenging.

“It was a par score; it was defendable. I felt after the heavy roller, it got better in the second innings. In the

first innings, the bowlers got some grip, and the slower ones did well. I thought 230 would have been a par score (and) a score around 240 would have been challeng- ing,” he said. The Royals' captain said Sooryavanshi's 96 was a calculated knock.

“I can't put it into words, there's one way where you slog and score many runs. But he doesn't slog, you could see his innings today - he calculates and plays his shots,” he said.

“I can't say how, but hope- fully he will go on to do well in his career, do well for the Rajasthan Royals and win us a second title.”

Riyan praised his side for making the playoffs despite their inexperience.

He is more than ready, says Sanga on India call up for Sooryavanshi

BHARAT SHARMA
■ Mullanpur

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's per- formance against world class bowlers in the IPL is an indi- cator that he is more than ready to play for India, said Sri Lankan legend and Rajasthan Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara.

The 15-year-old had a phe- nomenal first full season in the IPL as he aggregated 776 runs at a staggering strike rate of 237.31. He could well end up as the leading run getter of the tournament if Shubman Gill or Sai Sudharsan don't surpass him in the final on Sunday.

Having taken the likes of Jasprit Bumrah, Kagiso Rabada and Pat Cummins to the cleaners over the course



of the two month long com- petition, Sooryavanshi has reinforced the popular belief that he is rarest of rare who would serve India for long.

After endorsements from former cricketers including the legendary Sunil Gavaskar,

the world, I think he's more than ready to take on any challenge that you throw at him. And I'm sure that he'll get that call-up very, very soon,” said the Sri Lankan after Royals' exit from the IPL.

“He's batted with a lot of maturity, he has shouldered the responsibility of that opening partnership so well for this season,” he added.

India's next T20 assign- ment is in Ireland late June and there is a strong likeli- hood of Sooryavanshi making his international debut in that series.

After a 29-ball 97 in Eliminator, the teenager switched gears for 96 off 47 balls on Friday night, showing he can adapt if the situation demands.

“Yeah, I thought he batted

brilliantly. It was a much tougher batting innings with wickets falling around him and he held his nerve and really got us to a defendable total. The guy, for 15 years old, is very mature, he reads the game really well, he reads sit- uations well and he's got no fear. “I think we are very, very proud of the season that he's had and we just want to make sure that he keeps going, keeps that intent, keeps that no-fear attitude and keeps growing. I think he's going to be even better as the years go by,” said Sangakkara. How do Royals plan to look after Sooryavanshi in between IPL seasons? “We all will have a plan for all our players, indi- vidualy, fielding, fitness work, any skill work that we

think they need. So for Vaibhav, it won't be different.

“We'll sit down with our medical team and then go through what he might need and then support him. We'll run our camps, he'll have enough practice opportuni- ties in Nagpur (Talegaon) with us. So we'll be keeping a very close eye, not just on Vaibhav, but all our players,” he said. Asked if he would coach a carefree soul like him differently to others, Sangakkara added: “We don't clutter his mind too much. He comes to all our team meetings, he con- tributes, he listens, and he does a lot of homework. He practises well and he reads bowlers well, he watches their videos and prepares himself really well.” (PTI)

Shubman Gill’s batting has just been phenomenal: Vikram Solanki

BHARAT SHARMA
■ Mullanpur

Gujarat Titans director of cricket Vikram Solanki has been blown away by the form and consistency his captain Shubman Gill has shown in the Indian Premier League. Gill has totalled 722 runs this season, scoring the bulk of the runs for his team alongside opening partner Sai Sudharsan (710). Both are operating at a healthy strike rate of 160.

Gill gave a batting master- class in his team's chase of 215 on Friday, steering the Titans to their third final in five seasons.

Gill, the Test and ODI captain for India, was dropped from the T20 side ahead of the World Cup

earlier this year. Considering his appetite for runs in the shortest format, Gill seems determined for a national comeback.

“It is on the back of a lot of hard work. I can only imagine all of the work that Shubman has put in through- out his career to get to where he is as far as batting is con- cerned. He's an exceptional young man, and sometimes you have to realise he is still a young man. To be playing the cricket that he is, to be batting the way he is, is just phenomenal,” said Solanki.

“... and Sai is no less so. He might be a little younger in his journey, but you can see that he takes a fine example from Shubman and under- stands that actually his skills are what you and I might



view as batsmanship — the sort of traditional form of batting — but there is no doubt in my mind that if a sit- uation, a circumstance requires them to up their run

rate, and that wicket actual- ly suits them playing that way, then they can adapt.”

Did Gill come into this IPL with a different mindset fol- lowing his exclusion from

the T20 World Cup squad? “He was preparing exactly as he has done before. He's a wonderful talent. T20 cricket is a format that you have to ride in different times as much as work hard when you're not playing well. He has played so much cricket. He's so experienced for somebody so young. He knows how to deal with all of those matters.”

“Success, (or) failure, pro- fessional sports is about dealing with exactly that. He was very measured when he arrived in our camp. His preparation has been on point as it always is. Regardless of what jersey he's wearing, his preparation is on point and that's exactly how he arrived this year,” said Solanki.

When asked for a response on rival teams and experts branding the Titans as a pre- dictable unit, Solanki did not have much to say.

“They are learned gentle- men of the game. We play a form of cricket that we trust and I don't really have any- thing else to say about it.”

On their meticulous plan- ning for Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Solanki chose to praise the teenager.

“I'll just say what an excep- tional innings he played (against Sunrisers Hyderabad). He continues to be a young man to be. It's defying any sort of logic to how he's taken on such expe- rienced international bowlers and played as well as he did today (against GT). I wish him well.” (PTI)

Odisha Gymnastics apologises after dead president’s name on letterhead causes embarrassment



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Bhubaneswar

Odisha Gymnastics Association secretary Ashok Kumar Sahoo has apologised for the continued use of late president Samir Dey's name on the association's official letterhead, describing it as an “unintentional mistake”.

The apology came after PTI reported that invoices related to the National Gymnastics Championships were issued on a letterhead bearing the name of Dey, who passed away in November 2024.

The Nationals concluded here earlier this month.

“I, Ashok Kumar Sahoo, Honorary Secretary, Odisha Gymnastics Association, took notice of the story published in different media channels about the mention of our late President Shri Samir Dey on our letterhead. It was an oversight error and an unintentional mistake,” Sahoo said in a statement.

“We run our association transparently. However, I

apologise for the oversight error and we will rectify it as soon as possible,” he added.

A complaint submitted to the commissioner-cum-sec- retary of Odisha's Sports and Youth Services Department has questioned how the OGA managed to secure nearly '98 lakh from the state gov- ernment for the 2026 National Gymnastics Championships even as invoices of more than '1.96- crore and official documents continued to carry the name of late Dey as president.

Sahoo had said that vice- president Dhiren Panda was currently functioning as the in-charge of the association but fresh letterheads had not been printed, resulting in the continued use of old stationery bearing Dey's name. The secretary had also said that the present committee, which has been in place for nearly two decades, would be dissolved by August and fresh elec- tions conducted in compli- ance with the National Sports Code.

Neeraj brother’s advice during Para Worlds helped me break my own record: Sumit Antil

SUMAN RAY ■ New Delhi

Legendary Neeraj Chopra's priceless advice during the World Para Championship last year resulted in his world record-obliterating effort of 74.82m, said two-time Paralympic gold medallist Sumit Antil.

Antil shattered his own world record of 73.29m by an incredible 1.53 metres in the men's javelin F64, to claim the gold at the 8th Indian Open Para Athletics International Championship in Bengaluru on Wednesday. The silver medalist — Maharashtra's Sandip Sargar with 62.88m was almost 12 metres short of him. “Neeraj bhai guides me from time to time. He came to



see my throw at the Para World Championship in New Delhi last year.

He pointed out a few shortcomings to me. So, I am benefiting from that here,” Antil told PTI in an exclusive Zoom interview from his hometown in Sonipat on

Antil, who had also trained alongside Tokyo Olympic gold medallist back in the day, couldn't stop talking about the kind of influence he has had on his career.

“Sometimes it feels nice to be compared with Neeraj bhai because he is also my idol,” you couldn't miss the pride in his voice. But there are times when unfair compari- son with Chopra had left him a trifle baffled. “Sometimes when the comparison is done in the wrong way you just wonder why it is happening because I and Neeraj are in absolutely different categories (able-bodied and para)-so why the comparison?”

“I mainly focus on taking tips from Neeraj bhai from

time to time and talking to him. As an athlete, he is very strong, but as a person, he is even better,” he observed.

Eyes trained on 80m mark: Antil has now trained his eyes on breaking the 75m mark consistently and even- tually get to 80m mark, which will be phenomenal marker for a differently abled athlete.

“In Bengaluru, I was expect- ing a little more than my final effort (best effort) . I was expecting to get around 75-76 metres on the sixth throw (but managed with 74.82). So, now I will try to make the 75 metres with consistency. I will try to get to the distance of 77-78 metres and repeat this performance again on the ground. So that I can

aim for a mark of 78-80 metres in future.”

Describing his build up to the event and how he eclipsed his own world record, the champion thrower said: “I had gone with full preparation to beat the world record because I have been chasing this record for the last 2.5 years.

“Finally, everything fell in line and when I learnt about the throw of 74.82m, it was nice to know that the record that I have been trying to break has been broken. To achieve that, we made many changes to tech- nique and rhythm, and I even lost seven kilos after my weight was measured in February-March.” (PTI)

THE TREND IS ASIAN

Fueled by midnight screen cravings, Indian diners are finally ditching cheap instant packets for the fierce, authentic flavours of real Asian street food, writes **SAKSHI PRIYA**

Japanese ramen is a quiet, almost meditative experience. You sit alone, focused entirely on the bowl. The broth runs deep and complex, built over hours from pork bones or dried fish. Korea takes that same noodle and turns it into a party. Spicy, loud, shared across a table with fried chicken and cold beer. Same noodle, completely different soul

For millions of young Indians, streaming Korean dramas, hunger points directly to the spicy red broth eaten outside a Seoul convenience store. People watch characters slurp instant noodles by the Han River and suddenly their local takeaway choices feel inadequate. This screen-induced craving laid the groundwork for a boom in authentic Asian dining across India.

The same obsession spills into Japanese cuisine. Catch anyone fresh off a flight from Tokyo and they will talk your ear off about Ichiran ramen. People come back talking about those tight, quiet wooden stalls where they drank rich pork broth until the bowl was dry. Nobody just gets the noodles anymore. You have to get a side of pan-fried gyoza, making sure to drag them through black vinegar first. Then there's the chicken karaage - a quick squeeze of lemon cuts right through the fat, and you wash the whole thing down with a freezing cold Japanese beer. The local crowd has figured out these rituals. They expect a properly cured, soft-boiled egg to

melt into their soup. For years, satisfying that craving in India meant facing two bad options. You could pay absurd hotel prices, or you could boil a salty packet of instant noodles at home. The middle ground did not exist. Urban professionals wanted actual depth of flavour, but they lacked the two hours required for a sit-down dinner.

Shivang Gupta and Ruhi Gupta recently opened NODO in Delhi's Khan Market to address this nationwide shift. It is a grab-and-go kitchen built to serve premium Asian food in under seven minutes. Rather than offering an overwhelming diner-style booklet, NODO keeps it ruthlessly simple. They operate out of three defined spaces, which are a sushi counter dubbed The Tokyo Street, the Dimsum Lab, and a custom ramen station. Seafood lovers usually point straight to the baked dynamite or the classic spicy tuna. On the flip side, the kitchen treats vegetarian orders with equal respect, serving up massive asparagus tempura rolls packed tight with rich cream cheese.

But the ramen really steals the show. Has anyone ever managed to finish the Kimchi Umami bowl without breaking a sweat? That fermented

soup base delivers a serious chilli kick. If you prefer a richer soup, they spend hours boiling down a classic tonkotsu. They also serve a notoriously hot Seoul fire buldak and a really well-balanced Thai coconut curry. You dictate exactly what goes into the bowl. Pick your noodle base first, then load up on the add ons. People tend to go all in, asking for cuts of fresh salmon, crab meat, cubes of tofu, and those soy marinated eggs with yolks that melt straight into the hot liquid. What really surprised me is how they handle the non meat options. The kitchen managed to recreate all eight of their rich broths into purely vegetarian formats that sacrifice absolutely zero flavour. NODO follows strict traditional prep, using alkaline water for their noodles to prevent the heavy stomach feeling that comes with cheap supermarket packets.

This focus on precision shows exactly how far the local palate has evolved. Augusto Cabrera, the Head Chef at BOYA, witnesses this shift daily. He points out that Japanese cuisine grew rapidly here because people are finally chasing refined, global experiences. They want the freshness and craftsmanship that Tokyo is famous for.

Interestingly, Cabrera notes a massive surge in Nikkei cuisine too. While a Japanese kitchen leans into quiet structure, a Korean table is total, beautiful chaos. You will probably fight over the last piece of tteokbokki. They drown these thick, chewy rice cakes in a spicy red sauce that is just so yummy. People literally grab crispy seaweed rolls to mop the plate clean. Then there is the japchae. Every single table seems to order a massive portion of these slippery glass noodles, which arrive hot, coated in roasted sesame oil, and mixed with thinly sliced vegetables.

And when Delhi hits peak summer heat, hot soup gets entirely replaced by mul naengmyeon. Slurping cold buckwheat noodles from a freezing, tangy broth feels like hitting a reset button. Japanese menus are seeing a similar shift towards shared grazing. Diners now match dry sake with charred yakitori skewers, or order plates of raw sashimi alongside agedashi tofu, letting the fried bean curd soak up all that warm, savoury dashi.

A whole generation is changing how it eats. Quick food no longer means processed junk. The sudden demand for authentic takeaway has traditional restaurants scrambling.



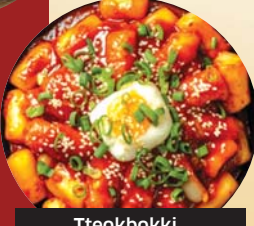
Kimchi is over 2,000 years old and packed with probiotics



Sushi was once considered fast food in Japan!



India's Korean noodle sales up 40 per cent



Tteokbokki



Bibimbap



Gimbap



Japanese Cold Tofu



Sushi



Japanese curry rice

The living silk knot



Every hand knot carries a story no machine ever could

SAKSHI PRIYA

A single knot of silk holds the weight of a century. When Partition divided the subcontinent, SD Nirula crossed from Bannu to Delhi with a quiet determination to protect India's handwoven legacy.

Decades later, curator Sunayana Chibba framed an evening of live santoor music around walls draped in intricate, hand-knotted wool and silk rugs. These carpets take months to finish, with thousands of individual threads mapping generations of regional folklore.

At the center of the room sat Nazir, a Kashmiri master weaver operating a traditional loom. His fingers secured each live hand-knot with rhythmic precision.

"How do you sustain this craft when the world moves so fast?" a voice asked over the wooden thud of his tools.

He pointed toward the half-finished Nizam pattern resting on his loom. Every single color used, he explained, carries the distinct memory of his ancestors. Machines will print flawless rugs in minutes, but they will never capture the deep sorrow hidden behind these traditional woven flower designs.

Nazir detailed a quiet crisis. Societies frequently fail to support the artists responsible for keeping history alive. These gifted creators face a forced silence, operating with zero stage left to stand on as cultural heritage spaces vanish.

With their recent inauguration at The Kunj in New Delhi, Kesari Home provides that missing platform. By funding the India Vision Foundation and partnering with rural families, Archana Nirula ensures human artistry survives intact. Will we let this heritage fade into machinery, or will we finally give these masters the stage they deserve?



ART CORNER

Jhuma Datta: Healing through the lens of nature

After surviving ovarian cancer, photographer Jhuma Datta turns to nature and the lens to rediscover healing, resilience, beauty, and emotional renewal

SAKSHI PRIYA

We spend so much of our time fighting the current when things fall apart. Maybe the real trick is simply letting the earth set the pace. That idea kept circling my mind at *Prakriti Raga: A Melody of Nature*. Jhuma Datta recently wrapped up this sixth solo photography show in New Delhi, and it felt completely different from a standard gallery evening. The opening night drew some of the most prominent names in the country. Chief Justice of India Surya Kant inaugurated the event, joined by Justice Vikram Nath, Justice PS Narasimha, Justice KV Viswanathan, and a former Vice President of India. Seeing them all standing there made one thing obvious. Datta has built a creative career from scratch, standing proudly on her own beside her husband, Supreme Court Judge Dipankar Datta.

When I asked her how falling ill changed everything, her answer came without hesitation. In 2016, an ovarian cancer diagnosis stopped her life cold. During the worst of the treatment, her camera and the natural world became her absolute lifelines. On her lowest days, just focusing on a tree or the open sky gave her some breathing room away from the reality of being ill. Nature never required her to be strong. It existed, and that steadiness helped her heal emotionally, reminding her she remained an integral part of something alive. On the days she felt physically wrecked, looking through a viewfinder at a random tree or an empty

sky gave her room to breathe. The outdoors expected absolutely nothing from her. That quiet presence mended her mind, proving she was still deeply rooted in a living world.

Because she used to paint, Datta brings a trained eye for colour and form to the lens. You see it in her global captures. Out in Kazakhstan, she photographed the Tiramisu Mountain. This whole landscape actually sat under the Tethys Sea a very long time ago. Today it leaves behind these amazing stacks of white, red and beige stone that pile up to look like a massive pastry. Nearby at Bokty Mountain, she set her camera on Polaris and left the shutter open for three hours in freezing conditions. The stars carved bright circles across the sky. The final image shows a truth we usually miss. We are always moving forward, even when we feel broken.

Her work also takes you to the freez-

ing sands of Jökulsárlón beach in Iceland. Arriving to a flat and grey sunset, Datta used her car headlights to light up the ice, creating a golden glow against the cold water. The surrounding walls featured Lake Antorno in Italy, bright tulips from Srinagar, Vagator's quiet beaches, and the Godafoss waterfalls.

Every photograph reads like life seen through a grateful survivor's eyes. By showcasing this immense beauty, her recently concluded exhibition leaves a lasting legacy that inspires a profound sense of responsibility to protect our precious planet for future generations.



CJI Surya Kant at Jhuma Datta's Prakriti Raga exhibition

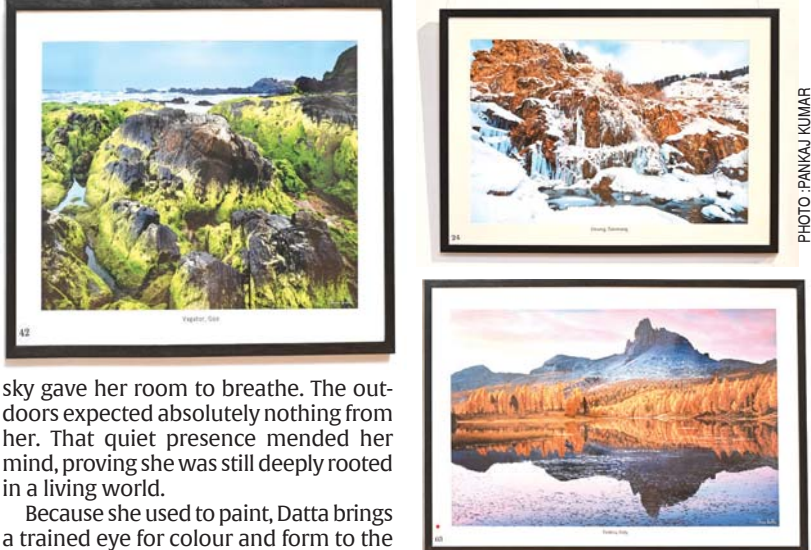


PHOTO: PANKAJ KUMAR

A medley of religion and faith



GYANESHWAR DAYAL

In a world where religion often divides, Taiwan does the opposite; it blends, layers, and celebrates. With over ten thousand temples, churches, and shrines packed into the island nation, it has earned its reputation as the most religiously diverse place in Asia. It is not merely tolerant of different faiths; it is a living mosaic where Buddhism, Taoism, folk religion, Christianity, and indigenous

spirituality coexist and intertwine. What makes Taiwan uniquely extraordinary is that its people rarely box themselves into a single belief system. According to a survey by Academia Sinica, 27.9 per cent of the population exclusively practises traditional folk religions, 19.8 per cent practises Buddhism, and 18.7 per cent practises Taoism. Yet, as many as 80 per cent of practitioners combine multiple traditions. Walk into any temple in Taipei or Tainan,



and you might find Buddhist statues sharing an altar with Taoist deities and Confucian ideals under one ornate, dragon-crowned roof.

Contemporary Taiwan is predominantly a mixture of Buddhist and Taoist, with 93 per cent of the population identifying with these traditions. Taiwan follows Mahayana Buddhism, emphasising compassion and communal salvation, whilst Taoism brings a rich pantheon of gods and the pursuit of harmony with nature. They do not compete; they complement. Taiwanese folk beliefs combine these traditions alongside the deification of local heroes and ancestor veneration. The goddess Mazu, protector of sailors, is beloved, with millions joining annual pilgrimages in her honour. These festivals are

living celebrations pulsing with devotion. Christianity arrived via Dutch and Spanish missionaries in the seventeenth century. Today, 5.5 per cent identify as Protestant and 1.4 per cent as Catholic. Strikingly, many chapels imitate classical Chinese architecture, blending Western faith with Eastern aesthetics. Taiwan's sixteen recognised indigenous peoples hold high Christian populations today, though their original animist traditions echo through oral traditions. Whilst only 4 per cent currently identify as followers of indigenous religions, 53 per cent feel a connection to those ways.

Taiwan's deep religious harmony is constitutionally guaranteed. Here, the divine wears many faces and is warmly welcomed through every single door.



TAIWAN'S ICONIC DRAGON AND TIGER PAGODAS RISE ABOVE LOTUS-FILLED WATERS, SHOWCASING THE ISLAND'S RICH CULTURAL HERITAGE

IN MEMORY OF



TEAM VIVA

Ujale apni yaadon ke hamare saath rehne do, Na jaane kis gali mein zindagi ki shaam ho jaye. The evening has finally descended upon one of the most brilliant custodians of our language. Bashir Badr is gone, leaving behind a profound quiet in a world already rapidly losing its cultural sanctuaries. We are watching the forced silence of our masters unfold in real-time, losing the very architects who kept our collective history breathing through their craft. It brings up the uncomfortable reality of how quickly we abandon our heritage, pushing our finest traditional artists into a forced silence with zero stage left to stand on. Now comes the hard part: keeping his words breathing in a world that barely stops to listen anymore.

BASHIR BADR'S POETRY STILL HOLDS OUR HEARTS

FOR SUGGESTIONS, FEEDBACK OR ADDITIONAL INFORMATION, PLEASE WRITE TO US AT FEATURES@DAILYPIONEER.COM

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The Pioneer AGENDA

A democracy cannot thrive where power remains unchecked and justice is reserved for a select few
— John Lewis



The Government is legally empowered to take over properties, companies, assets and the management of organisations, but with a caveat: it must be done for the public good and in a democratic manner. The legitimacy of such actions depends strictly on necessity, transparency, fair compensation and public accountability, free from any hidden motive. The Delhi Gymkhana is a case in point

From land disputes to land ailments



VIVEK KUMAR SINGH
The writer is an ex-IAS officer and is presently Chairman, RERA Bihar

"Land dispute" is perhaps the most casually used phrase in India's administrative vocabulary. It appears in police station diaries, revenue court files, district reviews and civil litigation with remarkable frequency. Yet, despite its widespread use, the expression conceals more than it explains. Almost every kind of land-related conflict — from a minor boundary disagreement to a convoluted title suit - gets loosely classified as a "land dispute".

This generic approach is not merely semantically weak. It is administratively damaging. It leads to misdiagnosis, procedural confusion and inappropriate remedies. Different problems are treated alike, often resulting in avoidable litigation, delayed interventions and, in many cases, escalation into violence. India's land governance system, therefore, needs a conceptual reset. Instead of treating all conflicts as "land disputes", administrators should begin to view them as "land ailments" requiring proper diagnosis, sensitivity assessment and category-specific treatment.

The distinction is important. A land ailment framework recognises that land-related problems are not uniform in nature, intensity or consequence. A fraudulent registration, an encroachment on government land, a mutation mismatch, a title conflict among legal heirs and a seasonal boundary clash between neighbouring farmers are fundamentally different issues. They emerge from different causes, involve different stakeholders and require different interventions. Yet, the administrative reflex often remains the same - push the matter into prolonged civil litigation or invoke preventive policing provisions to maintain peace. Neither approach addresses the root cause.

The overreliance on civil suits has created a situation in which even routine issues drift into years of litigation. Simultaneously, excessive reliance on police intervention converts many land matters into law-and-order exer-

cises without resolving the underlying administrative deficiency. The result is a governance vacuum in which neither the legal nor the executive system produces timely closure.

A diagnostic framework offers a middle path. The first step in such a framework is classification. Land ailments should be categorised into distinct groups: title-related ailments, possession-related ailments, record-related ailments, tenancy-related ailments, public land ailments and acquisition-related ailments.

Title-related ailments generally arise from competing ownership claims, defective conveyances or inheritance disputes. Possession-related ailments involve encroachments, forcible occupation or boundary overlaps. Record-related ailments stem from inconsistencies between registration records, mutation records and cadastral maps. Public land ailments concern encroachments on commons or government land. Acquisition-related ailments emerge from disputes over compensation, rehabilitation or alignment.

This classification itself can significantly improve administrative clarity. Once the precise nature of the ailment is identified, the administration can design an appropriate response rather than mechanically pushing every case into the same procedural pipeline.

The second element is risk assessment. Not all land ailments carry equal potential for escalation. A dormant title dispute between absentee owners may not require urgent intervention, whereas a boundary dispute during the sowing season can rapidly deteriorate into violence. Encroachments involving community land may trigger collective mobilisation and political intervention. District administrations should, therefore, adopt a simple sensitivity matrix. Factors such as prior violence, proximity between parties, agricultural cycles, community mobilisation, political involvement and the strategic value of the land should be assessed systematically. Cases can then be categorised into low-, medium- and high-risk categories.

Such triage has practical value. Low-risk cases can be resolved at the circle/tehsil level through demarcation or mutation correction. Medium-risk cases may require supervision at the sub-divisional level. High-risk cases should come under the joint monitoring of the District Magistrate and Superintendent of Police. This allows

administrative attention to be directed where it is most needed.

The third pillar of the framework is category-specific treatment. Boundary- and possession-related ailments require rapid on-site demarcation using modern survey tools. Record-related ailments require synchronisation between registration and revenue databases. Community land ailments require geo-tagging, encroachment inventories and public disclosure. Acquisition-related ailments require transparent compensation mechanisms and grievance-redressal systems.

Technology can play a transformative role here. India's land governance architecture still suffers from fragmentation between registration records, mutation records and cadastral maps.

CONTINUED ON >> PII

Legacy of Government takeovers in India



J GOIKRISHNAN

The Government's power to take over property has become a hot topic after the Central Government issued a notice to the Delhi Gymkhana Club. The Government's power to take over has a long history. Earlier, the 'Right to Property' was a Fundamental Right, and the Government faced hardships in road and infrastructure construction. In 1971, Indira Gandhi removed

the Right to Property from the Fundamental Rights and changed the rule that, by paying a price, the Government can take over any property. The price decided by the Government and the people challenging it in the courts were curtailed.

This power of the Government was changed by the Janata Party Government in 1978 by making the Right to Property a Legal Right, and the prices of compensation were increased, and people could challenge the takeover in courts. Basically, the Government has to declare the reason or purpose for taking over a property. This was not seen in the Gymkhana Club eviction notice. The matter is now before the Delhi High Court, and this case will go on for many years, and both parties will go up to the Supreme Court. Many such high-profile takeover cases are now in court. During the initial days of the arguments, the Club cited the landmark judgment on Indian Express. When *Indian Express* was battling the Rajiv Gandhi Government, citing some changes made inside the building as a violation of land allotment, the Government issued a takeover notice. In the end, *Indian Express* won the case. Citing a series of violations, the Government has issued orders to take over the nearby Link House and Herald House. These two cases are still pending in different courts.

The Link House case has been pending in the Delhi High Court for the past six years. The Government won the case in the erstwhile *National Herald* newspaper's publishing office, Herald House, takeover. Now the matter has been pending in the Supreme Court since 2019. Meanwhile, the Enforcement Directorate (ED), in 2025, provisionally attached National Herald's properties in Delhi, Mumbai and Lucknow.

Recently, the Gujarat Government has taken over the land allotted to Asaram Bapu. The reason cited for the takeover was to construct a new stadium for the Commonwealth Games 2030. The High Court also ratified the Government's decision. Now the case is pending in the Supreme Court.

Not only properties, but the Government can attach anything. Indira Gandhi, during the Emergency period, appointed five directors in the Indian Express newspaper company in a bid to take over from Ram Nath Goenka. But the Government's attempt failed due to Goenka's objections at the very first board meeting. He picked a fight with

one of the Government-appointed directors, Congress leader Kamal Nath, and got the board meeting called off. Details of this incident are described verbatim in Arun Shourie's recent book, *The Commissioner For Lost Causes*. The *Times of India* was managed by a committee headed by Bombay High Court judges for more than 10 years when the promoters were arrested for financial violations, and Indira Gandhi, in the mid-1970s, returned the newspaper to the promoters.

India's famous takeover was in 1953 when Jawaharlal Nehru ordered the acquisition of Air India from the Tata Group. Another was the nationalisation of banks by Indira Gandhi in 1969, citing financial violations by private bankers. Many educational institutions were also taken over by the Government, citing mismanagement and corruption.

THE BJP GOVERNMENT OF UTTARAKHAND IN 2018 PASSED AN ACT TO TAKE OVER 51 TEMPLES IN THE STATE, INCLUDING KEDARNATH AND BADRINATH TEMPLES

In South India, many temples were taken over by the Government by creating a board to run the administration of temples. In Tamil Nadu, during the DMK regime, many temples were taken over, citing mismanagement. In 2014, the Supreme Court passed a landmark judgment on the takeover of a temple in a case filed by Subramanian Swamy. The apex court ordered that if there is any mismanagement in temple administration, the Government can take over and appoint a new management to rectify the problem, and it must be handed back to believers/priests within three years. The BJP Government of Uttarakhand, in 2018, passed an Act to take over 51 temples in the state, including Kedarnath and Badrinath Temples. The Government never explained why this Act was brought in. Due to huge protests from people and priests, after two years the Government withdrew the Act to save its skin from public anger.

The writer is Associate Editor, *The Pioneer*

A 112-year old heritage: Why Delhi cannot afford to lose the Gymkhana Club

NAVINA JAJA

Delhi has never been a city built through erasure. It has always evolved through accumulation. The city's identity lies not in uniformity, but in layering — in the ability to preserve different historical rhythms simultaneously.

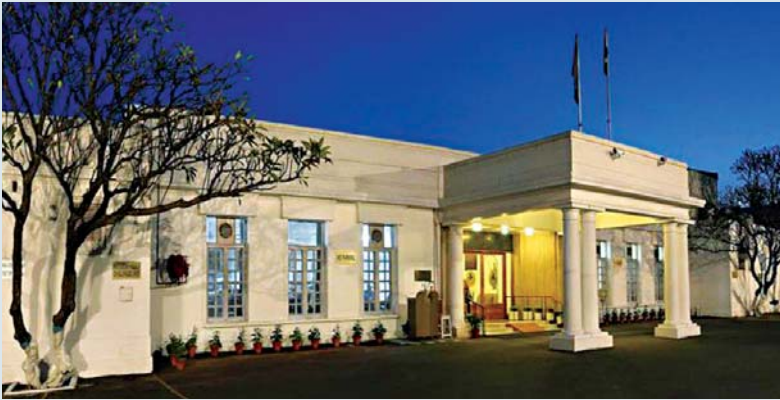
This is why Delhi cannot be understood solely through monuments of state power. Its real autobiography lies equally in the spaces where diplomacy unfolded, where political negotiations occurred informally, where cuisine, sport, etiquette, conversation and governance intersected, and where generations inherited not simply buildings but ways of inhabiting the city. Within this larger historical manuscript of Delhi, the Delhi Gymkhana Club occupies a singular place.

Established in 1913 as the "Imperial Delhi Gymkhana Club", the institution

emerged during the creation of New Delhi itself. Yet, over more than a century, it transcended the politics of its origin and became woven into the civic memory of the capital. Today, the Gymkhana survives not merely as a club, nor merely as a historic structure, but as one of Delhi's most important living heritage landscapes - a place where diplomacy, governance, sport, cuisine, ecology, sociability, prestige and memory continue to coexist.

Its significance lies precisely in the fact that it remains inhabited history.

Unlike static monuments, the Gymkhana functions as a living civic environment. Its lawns, verandahs, courts, dining halls, kitchens, bars, reading rooms and gardens preserve inherited rituals of gathering and encounter. Its atmosphere has been shaped not only by architecture, but by continuity itself - by the fact that gen-



erations have continued to use the space as part of Delhi's civic life.

Certain institutions become important because they preserve not only structures, but habits of civilisation. Delhi Gymkhana belongs to this cate-

gory. The political and diplomatic importance of Delhi Gymkhana forms an essential part of its historical significance. The informal political discussions and negotiations that ultimately paved the way for the Gandhi-Irwin

Pact of 1931 were notably held within the club's premises. The pact represented one of the defining moments in India's freedom movement, symbolising a critical stage in the constitutional negotiations between the national-ist movement and imperial authority.

Delhi during this period was not governed solely through official chambers. The city's political culture unfolded equally through gardens, residences, salons, clubs and semi-public civic spaces, where relationships, conversations and informal negotiations shaped political outcomes. Mahatma Gandhi, Lord Irwin and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel belonged to a political era in which the social geography of Delhi formed part of the architecture of governance itself. The Gymkhana evolved into one of Delhi's principal environments of soft cultural diplomacy. Long before luxury hotels became

diplomatic stages, the Gymkhana functioned as one of the capital's most important social and diplomatic salons. Situated within the diplomatic geography of New Delhi and surrounded by embassies and state institutions, the Gymkhana continues to function as a softer extension of the capital's international identity. It represents not simply elite sociability, but the diplomacy of atmosphere - the manner in which a capital projects continuity, hospitality, prestige and institutional memory.

One of the central debates surrounding institutions such as Delhi Gymkhana concerns privilege. Yet privilege itself possesses a history, and cities mature when they learn to preserve the full complexity of their social evolution rather than flattening it into simplistic moral categories.

CONTINUED ON >> PII

“DARKNESS CANNOT DRIVE
DARKNESS; LIGHT CAN DO THAT. HATE
CANNOT DRIVE OUT HATE; LOVE CAN
DO THAT”
— MARTIN LUTHAR KING

Extortion Crackdown: Wake-up Call for South Asians in Canada



SURJIT SINGH FLORA
Veteran journalist and freelance writer based in Brampton Canada

Seventeen arrests, 106 charges, and a trail that reached across Canada and into the United States made this more than a routine police sweep. Canadian authorities say a joint extortion task force helped dismantle the “For Brothers” group, an international criminal network accused of threatening, shooting at, and setting fire to South Asian-owned businesses.

The case sits at the intersection of organised crime, border enforcement, and community fear. Police say the group used intimidation as a business model, then relied on mobility and cross-border ties to stay ahead of investigators. The response, in turn, drew in agencies that normally work separate cases, then pushed them into one file.

What police say the group was doing across Canada and beyond

Peel Regional Police say the alleged campaign reached restaurants, trucking businesses, and other South Asian-owned companies in the Greater Toronto Area and British Columbia. The pattern, according to police, included extortion demands, threats, arson, and shootings.

That mix matters because extortion crews do not need to rob every target in the same way. One business may get a phone call. Another may face a fire set overnight. A third may hear shots fired outside a storefront. The aim is the same in every case, force payment and keep the victim quiet.

Police said the alleged operation was not confined to one neighborhood or one province. Investigators linked the group to activity beyond Canada, which points to a wider criminal network rather than a local street crew. That wider reach makes the case harder to untangle, because money, people, and threats can move fast.

Why South Asian business owners were singled out

Extortion crews often target business owners who can be pressured into silence. Restaurants and trucking firms are common examples. They deal with cash, thin margins, long hours, and close community ties. That makes them easier to intimidate and harder to replace.

South Asian-owned businesses also often depend on trust inside tight-knit local circles. A threat against one owner can echo through a whole commercial strip.

Word spreads quickly, and fear spreads with it. For the people running these businesses, the pressure is personal. A threat to a storefront can feel like a threat to a family. That is what makes extortion so corrosive. It reaches far beyond the balance sheet.

How the violence helped the extortion scheme work

Police say the violence was not random. Arson, shootings, and threats were tools. They were used to send a message, not just to one victim but to everyone nearby.

A burned door or a shattered window tells other owners what may happen if they refuse to pay. A shooting does the same thing with more



force. In that sense, the violence becomes part of the collection system. It is meant to keep the money moving and the complaints low.

The damage lasts even when no one is hurt. Business owners may cut hours, move locations, or stop answering unknown calls. Families may change routines. Staff may leave. The costs pile up long after the news fades.

How the joint extortion task force was built to move faster

The response began as a full-time task force in September 2025, after extortion reports kept stacking up and individual cases started to look connected. Peel Regional Police led the effort with provincial and federal partners, while investigators also worked with agencies across borders.

Police said the wider investigation involved Peel Regional Police, the Ontario Provincial Police, the Canada Border Services Agency, Surrey Police Service, and the FBI. Canadian organized-crime cases often need that kind of mix. The RCMP and CFSEU-B.C. also play important roles in similar files, because cross-border groups do not stop at city limits or provincial lines.

The reason for the special team was simple. Separate investigations can miss the pattern. A shooting in one area, a threat in another, and a drug file somewhere else may all look unrelated at first. Put the files together, and the shape of the network starts to appear.

Why multi-agency cooperation matters in organised crime cases

Each agency brings a different tool. Local police see the street-level complaints and preserve the immediate evidence. Provincial units can connect patterns across divisions. Border officers can track travel, shipments, and immigration status. Federal partners can widen the view when a case crosses borders.

That matters in extortion cases because the pressure often moves faster than any single unit can keep up. A victim may be in one city, a suspect in another, and the money somewhere else entirely. Shared intelligence turns separate fragments into one picture.

In plain terms, the task force was built to stop the group from hiding inside the gaps between

Criminal charges and immigration consequences are separate processes. One runs through the courts. The other runs through Canada's immigration system. Still, they can move at the same time when police and border officials believe a suspect may be inadmissible

agencies. Those gaps are where organised crime often grows.

What the task force had already uncovered before the arrests

By the time the arrests came in May 2026, the task force had already collected enough evidence to support a large charge sheet. Police said the probe had taken over multiple files and linked them into one organised-crime investigation.

That work produced the charge package that followed. Police said the group's alleged conduct included extortion, violence, arson, and drug-related offenses. The scale of the case suggests a long build, not a quick reaction.

Authorities also said the early stages of the probe helped uncover people and records tied to the network before the arrests were made public. That kind of groundwork is often what turns a string of complaints into a coordinated takedown.

What the arrests and charges reveal about the scope of the case

Police arrested 17 men, many of Punjabi origin, from places including Brampton, Surrey, British Columbia, and Manteca, California. The 106 charges cover a broad mix of alleged offenses, including extortion, firearms violations, arson, and drug-related counts.

The numbers matter because they show range. This was not treated as one isolated extortion file. It was handled as a network with multiple roles and multiple points of contact. Police said more arrests could still follow, which suggests the case is not closed.

The spread also shows how the group allegedly

operated across borders. A person in one province could support threats in another. A suspect in the United States could still be part of the chain. That is how modern organised crime often works, through distance, not despite it.

The evidence police say they seized

Police said investigators recovered illegal firearms, illicit drugs, fraudulent identification documents, and other suspicious records. Each item adds a different layer to the case.

Illegal guns support claims of intimidation and violence. Drugs point to another revenue stream. False IDs can help people move, hide, or pose as someone else. Records can show contacts, cash flows, or travel links. Put together, they can sketch the outline of a network that relies on more than extortion alone.

None of that proves guilt by itself, of course. It does show why police treated the file as organised crime instead of a one-off dispute. The evidence points to structure.

Why the case stretches across provinces and into the United States

Investigators said the network had links across Ontario, British Columbia, the United States, and India. That kind of spread matters because it changes how the case has to be handled.

A local extortion crew can be investigated with local tools. A cross-border network cannot. Money may move through one country while threats are made in another. People may live in one place and work criminal roles in another. That makes coordination essential.

The case also fits a wider pattern Canadian police have seen before, where commercial trucking corridors and major metro areas are used for organised crime, drug movement, and identity fraud. The same routes that carry freight can also carry risk.

How immigration enforcement is becoming part of the crackdown

The Canada Border Services Agency has opened immigration cases tied to suspected extortion activity, and police said several people were detained. According to the latest figures shared by investigators, six of the 17 charged may face

immigration action.

Criminal charges and immigration consequences are separate processes. One runs through the courts. The other runs through Canada's immigration system. Still, they can move at the same time when police and border officials believe a suspect may be inadmissible.

That gives authorities another way to disrupt a network. Even when criminal cases take months or years, immigration steps can move faster. For groups that depend on movement across borders, that matters.

What removal proceedings mean for suspects without Canadian status

In plain language, “inadmissible” means a person may not be allowed to stay in Canada. The reason can be a criminal charge, a conviction, false documents, or other concerns under immigration law.

Removal proceedings are the steps that can lead to someone being sent out of the country. CBSA can start those steps while a criminal case is still pending. That does not erase the court case. It adds another path for enforcement.

For police, that tool can be useful in organized-crime investigations because it can cut off access, travel, and support networks. For suspects without Canadian status, it can change the entire case before a trial is finished.

Why border and police agencies are treating extortion as a national security issue

Extortion used to be seen, in many places, as a local crime with local victims. That view has changed. When crews use firearms, fake IDs, drugs, and cross-border contacts, the file looks different.

It also affects more than one business. Repeated extortion waves can weaken trust in police, scare off investment, and make whole communities feel unprotected. Border agencies care because the same routes that move people can also move weapons and money. That is why the crackdown involved more than a single police department. The threat is wider than one neighborhood, so the response is wider too.

What the crackdown means for the South Asian community now

The immediate effect of the arrests is relief for some business owners, but fear does not vanish overnight. Many owners in the South Asian community have spent months hearing threats, checking cameras, and wondering which call might be the next one.

Police have urged victims not to pay extortion demands and to report threats to law enforcement or Crime Stoppers. That advice has come with a hard truth. Silence helps the people making the threats, and fear can spread faster than any police bulletin. The larger damage is harder to measure. Families change routines. Owners cut back on hours. Some people decide the cost of staying open is too high. When that happens, extortion stops being a single crime and becomes a drag on an entire community. The arrests matter because they show how extortion, violence, and immigration enforcement now overlap in major organised-crime cases. Canadian police are no longer treating these files as isolated threats to one shop or one street.

For South Asian communities, the case is a reminder that targeted extortion can reach into daily life with alarming ease. For police, it shows that the people behind these networks can move across borders, hide behind false papers, and use fear as a shield. The challenge now is not only breaking one group. It is stopping the next crew from using the same methods, the same routes, and the same silence.

FROM AGENDA COVER

From land disputes to land ailments

Integrated Land Information Systems can substantially reduce these inconsistencies. GIS mapping, drone surveys and Satellite Image Time Series (SITS) can help detect encroachments and monitor land-use changes in near real time.

Yet technology alone cannot solve the problem. Administrative philosophy must evolve alongside it. India has already experimented with specialised legal mechanisms which recognise that many so-called “land disputes” are, in fact, administrative and possession-related ailments requiring swift executive intervention rather than prolonged civil litigation. The Bihar Land Disputes Resolution Act, 2009, was conceived precisely for this purpose. The law empowered designated authorities to address disputes relating to possession, boundary demarcation, unlawful dispossession and certain categories of record inconsistencies through a time-bound quasi-judicial process. Its utility lay not merely in dispute resolution, but in preventing routine land conflicts from escalating into law-and-order situations or drifting into decades of civil litigation.

The importance of such a framework is often underestimated. In practice, a large number of land conflicts arise not from complex title questions, but from gaps between records, possession and field realities. By creating a specialised institutional mechanism, the Bihar model attempted to provide rapid administrative correction at the local level while reducing pressure on civil courts and police systems.

This does not, however, diminish the importance of mutation or updated revenue records. Mutation remains the State's closest administrative approximation of the current title and lawful possession. While it may not confer absolute ownership, dismissing it merely as a fiscal entry weakens the credibility of land administration itself. A balanced approach would therefore treat mutation as a “best-claim” indicator of current title and possession, subject to judicial scrutiny, while simultaneously strengthening specialised administrative mechanisms for rapid field-level dispute resolution. India may also need to rethink its larger approach to titling. The binary distinction between “conclusive” and “presumptive” titles is often mis-

leading because title itself is dynamic and transaction-driven.

The implications of this framework extend beyond dispute resolution. Land governance affects investment, infrastructure, agricultural productivity and social stability. Delayed acquisition, uncertain records and recurring encroachments increase transaction costs and erode public trust. Conversely, timely diagnosis and resolution can significantly improve governance outcomes.

The administrative structure required for such a transition already exists. Circle/Tehsil Offices, Sub-Divisional Offices, District Administrations and Police systems can be integrated into a layered framework of diagnosis, triage and treatment. What is missing is conceptual clarity and procedural discipline.

The language of “land disputes” belongs to an older era of reactive governance. India now requires a more sophisticated framework that treats land-related conflicts not merely as disputes to be contained, but as ailments to be diagnosed, treated and prevented. That transition may appear semantic at first glance. In reality, however, it could fundamentally transform the quality of land governance in India.

The writer is an ex-IAS officer and is presently Chairman, RERA Bihar. He served as Principal Secretary, Department of Revenue and Land Reforms, Bihar

A 112-year old heritage: Why Delhi cannot...

Delhi has always contained layered worlds of privilege. Mughal courts, aristocratic havelis, princely salons, colonial institutions, diplomatic enclaves, and post-Independence bureaucratic cultures all formed part of the city's historical ecology. These spaces reveal how successive eras imagined prestige, etiquette, influence, and public life. The Gymkhana preserves one such layer within the city's autobiography.

Its value lies not in celebrating privilege uncritically, but in preserving the historical memory of how Delhi functioned across different political periods. A mature civilisation does not preserve only the heritage of the street and the bazaar; it



also preserves the heritage of diplomacy, ceremony, refinement, and institutional culture. The city's greatness lies precisely in its coexistence of worlds — common and elite, public and ceremonial, chaotic and refined. To erase every inherited institution associated with prestige would not democratise history; it would impoverish it.

The word Gymkhana itself reflects the layered cultural inheritance of South Asia. The suffix khana in Persian, Urdu, and Hindustani traditions signifies a chamber, house, or place of gathering. It was never merely a sports club. Its verandahs, tea rooms, kitchens, lawns, dining spaces, and bars created an environment where diplomacy, food, sport, governance, and conversation intersected within the everyday life of the capital. Delhi has long conducted politics not only through formal institutions but through gatherings, salons, dinners, and spaces of sociability where civic culture was negotiated informally.

The sporting history of Delhi Gymkhana constitutes one of its most important inheritances. The club developed some of the capital's most distinguished sporting facilities for tennis, cricket, squash, swimming, billiards, and equestrian culture. These spaces were never simply recreational amenities; they became part of Delhi's ceremonial and civic identity. Among these facilities, the

historic grass tennis courts possess particular significance. Delhi Gymkhana's grass courts are not merely playing surfaces. They preserve one of the last surviving traditions of grass-court tennis in India, a sporting lineage stretching back through Davis Cup-era matches and a culture of tennis now increasingly rare within the subcontinent.

Its courts preserve not merely athletics, but an entire civic rhythm: afternoon matches beneath old trees, verandah conversations, post-game dinners, inherited sporting etiquette, and intergenerational traditions that together form part of the city's lived heritage.

The debate surrounding Delhi Gymkhana must also be understood within a broader Asian and international context. The great capitals of the world recognise that heritage does not survive solely through monuments. It survives equally through living institutions and ceremonial landscapes where memory continues to be inhabited.

London preserves its historic clubs and civic societies as part of its metropolitan identity. Singapore carefully conserves institutions such as the Tanglin Club and Singapore Cricket Club amidst rapid modernisation because it understands that continuity creates prestige. Hong Kong retains historic civic institutions alongside contemporary skyscrapers. Tokyo protects ceremonial gardens and inherit-

ed social landscapes despite immense urban density. These cities recognise that global capitals derive identity not only from economic infrastructure but from continuity of atmosphere and memory. Delhi Gymkhana belongs to this larger Asian tradition of living heritage institutions.

Ecology, Air Pollution, and the Green Lungs of the Capital. The grounds form part of one of the last surviving low-density green lungs of central Delhi. In a city struggling with severe air pollution, shrinking tree cover, rising temperatures, and increasing congestion, these open landscapes possess immense environmental significance extending far beyond private membership.

The lawns, mature trees, gardens, and breathing spaces preserve part of the original ecological logic of New Delhi, a city conceived through permeability, ceremonial greens, tree-lined avenues, and climatic balance. These landscapes were never ornamental luxuries. They formed part of the environmental infrastructure of the capital itself. The preservation of such landscapes therefore becomes a civic necessity.

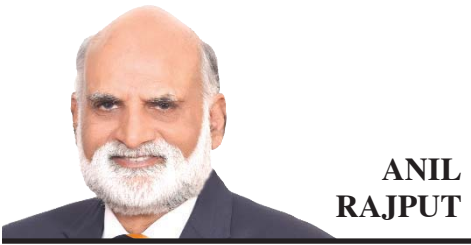
Living heritage landscapes accumulate atmosphere across generations. Once dismantled, they cannot simply be reconstructed elsewhere. One may recreate walls and architecture, but not continuity. Destroying such a place would resemble dismantling a Renaissance theatre and later attempting to reproduce its atmosphere inside a museum.

Delhi Gymkhana has already entered the realm of recognised heritage through the manner in which its grass courts, historic architecture, ceremonial landscapes, and long sporting afterlife have become embedded within Delhi's civic memory rather than remaining confined to the private history of a club. Over time, the institution has evolved into what may be understood as a living ‘heritagescape’, a historical environment where sport, diplomacy, ecology, architecture, and sociability collectively contribute to the cultural identity of the capital city. Delhi Gymkhana is one such environment. To remove it would not merely alter a parcel of land. It would tear out one of the living pages from the manuscript of Delhi itself.

Navina Jafa is a cultural heritage historian, author, Fulbright Scholar, renowned Kathak dancer, and expert on heritage tourism

“PEOPLE WILL TRAVEL ANYWHERE
FOR GOOD FOOD – IT’S CRAZY”
— RENE REDZEPI

Vibhuvana Sankashti: A culinary expression of prayer and discipline



ANIL
RAJPUT

Vibhuvana Sankashti, a sacred observance dedicated to Lord Ganesha, revered as the remover of obstacles, the guardian of wisdom and auspicious beginnings, is a rare form of Sankashti Chaturthi celebrated during the spiritually significant Adhik Maas. While Sankashti Chaturthi is observed every month on the fourth lunar day of Krishna Paksha, the waning phase of the Moon after the full moon, Vibhuvana Sankashti gains a special significance because it occurs within Adhik Maas, the additional month periodically added to the Hindu calendar to align the lunar and solar cycles. Its rarity gives the occasion a heightened devotional importance, marked by fasting, prayer and self-discipline. Like many sacred occasions in Indian tradition, food on this day is more than nourishment after abstinence; it becomes an expression of devotion itself. The cuisine reflects simplicity, purity and sacred offering, where vrat preparations, milk-based dishes and Lord Ganesha's beloved sweets such as modaks and laddoos become symbols of faith, gratitude and inner balance.

The significance of Vibhuvana Sankashti arises from the broader Hindu tradition of observing fasting and prayer as ways of seeking relief from difficulties and inviting auspiciousness into life. Over time, the observance came to acquire a distinct devotional significance, particularly because of its association with the sacred period of Adhik Maas. Across regions and communities, devotees may observe day-long fasting, visit Ganesha temples, recite sacred narratives and complete rituals connected with moon sighting before breaking the vrat. Homes and shrines are adorned with flowers, durva grass and garlands that hold special significance in Ganesha worship, while many devotees wear traditional attire as a reflection of reverence. As with many Indian sacred observances, these rituals gradually shaped culinary traditions of their own, carrying the spirit of gratitude and sacred offering. Regular grains, onion, garlic and heavy foods are usually avoided by those following a traditional fast, while ingredients such as sabudana, samak rice, rajgira, kuttu, sing-



hara, potato, sweet potato, peanuts, milk, curd, coconut, jaggery, fruits and rock salt form the heart of the meal.

The day usually begins before the food itself. The home is cleaned, the place of worship is prepared, and Lord Ganesha is offered flowers, durva, lamps, incense and sweets. The food prepared for Vibhuvana Sankashti is first offered to the deity, then distributed as prasad, and only afterwards enjoyed by the family. The prasad itself becomes a symbol of devotion and supplication that marks the spirit of the occasion.

Among the most familiar savoury preparations associated with Sankashti fasting is sabudana khichdi, prepared by soaking tapioca pearls until they soften and then cooking them gently with roasted peanuts, cumin, green chilli, boiled potato and rock salt. Its success lies in patience because sabudana must be soaked with care so that the grains remain separate rather than turn sticky. Often, it is finished with fresh coriander and lemon juice, giving the dish both energy and lightness after a day of fasting. Alongside it, sabudana vada offers a more festive variation to the same ingredients. Mashed potatoes, soaked sabudana, crushed peanuts and mild spices are shaped into small patties and fried until crisp. When eaten after the evening puja with curd or a simple chutney, it provides more sustenance without breaking the rules of vrat food.

Potatoes and root vegetables occupy an important place because they offer nourishment without the heaviness of regular grains. Vrat wale also are usually made with boiled potatoes simmered in a light gravy of cumin, green chilli, rock salt and sometimes curd, creating a dish that is soft, warm and suitable with puris. Jeera aloo, simpler and drier, is prepared by tossing potatoes with cumin, rock salt and a little ghee, allowing the flavour of the vegetable to remain central. Dahi aloo brings curd into the preparation, making the dish cooling and gentle on the stomach.

Sweet potato and arbi deepen this savoury range. Shakarkandi chaat is made by roasting or boiling sweet potatoes, cutting them into pieces and seasoning them with rock salt, roasted cumin, lemon and sometimes a little chilli. It is sweet, tangy and filling, and it reflects the Indian ability to create festive flavour from the simplest produce. Arbi fry, prepared with colocasia sliced and cooked until lightly crisp, offers an earthier taste. In some homes it is pan-fried with cumin and rock salt, while in others it is made slightly more elaborate with vrat-friendly spices. Both preparations provide substance without excessive richness.



ness, allowing the meal to remain devotional rather than indulgent.

Where a more complete post-vrat meal is prepared, fasting grains and flours become part of the recipes. Samak rice khichdi, made from barnyard millet, is one of the most widely used substitutes for rice during fasts. It is cooked with potatoes, peanuts, cumin and rock salt until soft, and may be served with curd or raita. Its texture makes it comforting after a long day, especially for elderly devotees or those who avoid fried food. The puris prepared on the occasion also hold pride of place. Depending on regional customs and fasting practices, households prepare different varieties of puris, ranging from traditional wheat puris to vrat-friendly versions made with flours such as rajgira, singhara or kuttu. The dough is typically kneaded with water or milk, sometimes enriched with mashed potato, banana or mild spices for texture and flavour, before being rolled into small discs and deep-fried until they puff into soft golden rounds. In some traditions, sweet puris prepared with jaggery and cardamom are also made, adding a gentle sweetness to the sacred meal. Rajgira puri, made from amaranth flour and Kuttu puri, made from buckwheat flour, are some of the more popular varieties. Singhara atta paratha, made from water chestnut flour, is sometimes used as a substitute for puris and is cooked on a tawa with ghee and served hot. Together, these preparations make the meal feel complete while retaining the discipline of fasting.

The accompaniments are equally important because they prevent the meal from becoming heavy or monotonous. Peanut chutney is made by grinding roasted peanuts with green chilli, cumin, rock salt and curd or lemon, giving the plate a nutty depth. Cucumber raita cools the body and balances fried foods, while plain curd itself is often treated as one of the simplest and most sattvic supports for a vrat meal. In some homes, grated coconut, roasted cumin and fresh coriander are added to curd-based accompaniments. Such additions may appear modest, but they show the refinement of Indian fasting cuisine, where balance is created through texture, temperature and digestive wisdom.

No Sankashti associated with Lord Ganesha can be complete without the memory of modak. Kadachie modak, especially beloved in Maharashtrian households, is made with a rice flour covering and a filling of coconut and jaggery, gently steamed until soft and fragrant. Though regular rice flour may not be used by every fasting



household, the dish remains culturally connected with Ganesha as a symbol of sweetness, knowledge and fulfillment. Some families prepare vrat-friendly versions using permitted flours, while others offer modak symbolically as naivedya and keep the personal meal simpler. Fried modak gives a different texture, with a crisp outer shell and sweet filling, and is often made when the occasion is observed with a more festive household meal. The act of shaping modak by hand itself becomes a form of devotion, requiring attention, patience and care.

The sweet offerings extend beyond modak and reveal the breadth of vrat cuisine. Coconut laddoo is prepared by cooking grated coconut with jaggery or sugar until it binds into soft rounds, sometimes scented with cardamom. Til-gud laddoo brings together sesame and jaggery, creating a warming sweet that is particularly valued in cooler seasons, though it may be made at other times according to family practice. Rajgira laddoo, made from popped amaranth and jaggery, is both light and nourishing, and its crisp texture makes it a popular fasting sweet. These laddoos are not merely desserts but a source of energy, as they are made from ingredients that sustain and energize the body after long hours of fasting.

Milk-based sweets add another layer of fulfillment to the post-vrat meal. Sabudana kheer is made by simmering soaked sabudana in milk until the pearls turn translucent, then sweetening it with sugar or jaggery and flavouring it with cardamom. It is soft, cooling and easy to digest, which makes it suitable after a day of limited eating. Makhana kheer, prepared with roasted fox nuts simmered in milk, has a nutty softness and is often enriched with almonds, cashews or raisins where permitted. Shrikhand, made from strained curd mixed with sugar and cardamom, offers a creamy and cooling sweet that is especially valued in western Indian homes. These sweets are often taken after the main prasad, because they also serve the purpose of restoration.

The lighter end of the meal belongs to fruit and sacred mixtures. Panchamrit, made with milk, curd, ghee, honey and sugar, occupies an important ritual place and is received as a blessing. Fruit chaat, made with bananas, apples, pomegranate, papaya or seasonal fruit, may be seasoned lightly with rock salt and roasted cumin. Banana with milk or curd is perhaps one of the simplest vrat foods, yet it

remains deeply practical because it gives energy without elaborate cooking. In many households, these foods are taken during the day by those who cannot remain completely without nourishment, while others receive them only after puja. This flexibility is part of the strength of Indian ritual culture, where discipline is honoured but human circumstance is also considered.

Beverages during Vibhuvana Sankashti follow the same principle of cooling, restoring and supporting the body. Chaas is prepared by diluting curd with water and seasoning it lightly with roasted cumin and rock salt. Sweet lassi provides greater nourishment and is often taken when the fast has been long. Nimbu pani offers hydration with lemon, water, sugar or jaggery and a small pinch of rock salt. Coconut water is valued for its natural lightness, while aam panna, kokum sherbet and bel sherbet appear according to region and season. In some homes, rose milk or simple fruit drinks are prepared for children and elderly family members. These beverages remind us that vrat cuisine is not only about what is prohibited, but also about how the body is protected while the mind remains turned towards prayer.

The fast is broken after sighting the moon, offering arghya while reciting prayers, and sharing prasad. The arghya usually centres on water, sometimes accompanied by flowers, akshat and other ritual ingredients according to family tradition. There is no display or extravagance in the arrangement, yet the plate feels abundant because every preparation carries intention. A small serving of samak rice khichdi, a spoon of dahi aloo, a piece of sabudana vada, a bowl of sabudana kheer and a single coconut laddoo can become a complete festive meal when received after reverence. The significance lies not in the variety of dishes alone but in the movement from fasting to offering, from offering to gratitude, and from gratitude to shared nourishment.

In conserving the cuisine associated with Vibhuvana Sankashti, we preserve more than a list of fasting recipes. We preserve an inherited understanding that food becomes integral to spiritual intent, a process of purification and a supplication for divine guidance. I believe such observances act also as a reminder that our culinary heritage is not built only on feasts, but also on devotion, offerings to divinity and sharing with the community. It is my belief that Vibhuvana Sankashti, rare in its occurrence and steadfast in its discipline, teaches us that the simplest meal, prepared with sincerity and received with gratitude, can itself become a form of worship.

(The writer is Secretary, Cuisine India Society)

The salad side of summer

Crunch matters. Colour matters. And a good summer salad, it turns out, is exactly what the season ordered

TEAM VIVA

When the brutal heat finally hits this summer, absolutely nobody wants to stare down a heavy plate of hot food. Your body practically begs for something cold, loud, and fresh. We start craving serious crunch and bright, sharp dressings that wake up a tired mouth instead of putting us to sleep. That is the truth about a proper green bowl. It is not about dieting; it is strictly about surviving the afternoon without feeling sluggish. Café Delhi Heights seems to understand this rather well. Their current menu—especially the sharp Raw Papaya Salad and the chilled Salmon & Mango Bowl — makes a quietly convincing case for the salad as something worth genuinely looking forward to.



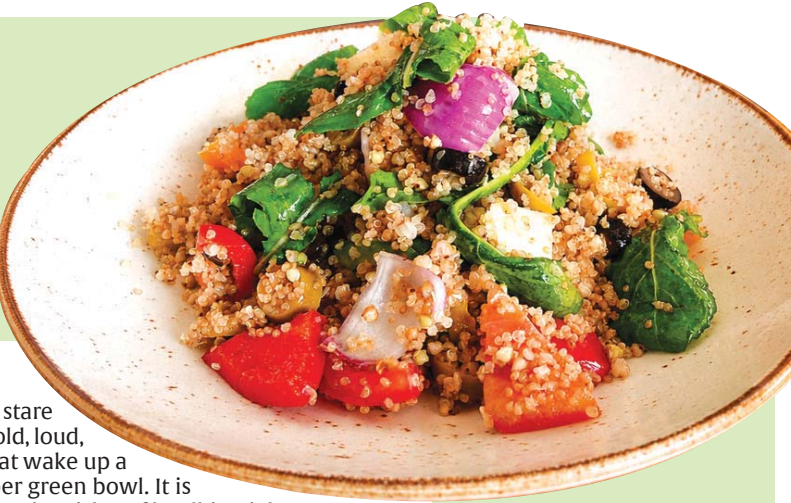
Roasted Beetroot Salad: Earthy, tangy and satisfying

Roasted beetroot sits at the centre of this one, earthy and soft, balanced out by sharp rocket leaves and a generous crumble of goat cheese. A honey and lemon dressing pulls it all together, and somehow the whole thing tastes both light and satisfying at once.



Greek Salad: Clean, bright and effortlessly free

The kitchen piles sharp raw onions, crisp bell peppers, salty black olives, and bursting cherry tomatoes over a fresh bed of chilled lettuce. Drenched in a punchy herb, lemon, and olive oil mix, then crowned with thick, creamy feta, it satisfies every salty, savory, and tangy summer craving.



Panzanella Salad Rustic, bold and utterly satisfying

Watch the kitchen toss massive, rustic bread chunks straight into warm vegetables, letting the crusts soak up all that sharp garlic, lemon, and olive oil. Showered with oregano and heavy parmesan, this messy, comforting bowl feels more like a hearty feast than a simple salad.

Raw Papaya Salad: Papaya that packs a punch

Shredded green papaya brings a loud crunch to the table. The kitchen aggressively tosses these raw strands in a sharp, intense sweet chili and lemon dressing that bites back immediately. Buried under a heavy handful of crushed peanuts, this bold plate wakes up your tired mouth instantly.



IN CAESAR WE CRUNCH



Tossing the Caesar Salad



Sprinkling Fresh Cilantro



The Perfect Caesar Plate

PHOTO: PANKAJ KUMAR

Flavours of Taiwan



GYANESHWAR DAYAL

Taiwan is often celebrated for its technological advancement, vibrant cities and rich cultural traditions, but one of its most fascinating attractions is its food culture. The island nation offers a remarkable culinary experience where global flavours coexist harmoniously with local traditions. For Indian travellers and food enthusiasts, Taiwan has increasingly become a delightful destination because it offers not only authentic Taiwanese cuisine but also some of the finest Indian food in East Asia. Taiwan's tea ceremonies are calming experience. Over the years, Indian cuisine has gained immense popularity across the world. Rich spices, diverse regional recipes and the balance of flavours have made Indian dishes universally loved. Taiwan, too, has embraced this trend warmly. Cities such as Taipei, Taichung and Kaohsiung have numerous Indian restaurants — Pooja's, Doon Valley, to name a few —, serving everything from butter chicken and biryani to masala dosa and paneer tikka. The growing

popularity of naan, curry and tandoori dishes among locals reflects how Indian food has become a cultural bridge connecting nations.

At the same time, Taiwanese cuisine has its own unique identity. Restaurant Chun shui Tang invented now world famous, bubble tea. Night markets across Taiwan are central to this culinary culture. Shilin Night Market offer an endless variety of street food that attracts locals and tourists alike. Iconic delicacies include beef noodle soup, xiao long bao and the world-famous bubble tea, which originated in Taiwan. Seafood lovers can enjoy oyster omelettes, grilled squid and fresh fish dishes, while healthy vegetarian options influenced by Buddhist traditions are widely available. What makes Taiwan truly special is the opportunity to enjoy both Indian and Taiwanese cuisines side by side. This coexistence of culinary traditions reflects Taiwan's openness, cosmopolitan spirit and cultural warmth, making it a paradise for food lovers.



Taiwan's iconic Baobing:

In Taiwan, this delicacy is served piled high with fresh fruits such as mango (pictured above), accompanied by finely shaved ice that blends beautifully with the flavours. Finished with a drizzle of condensed milk, it is cold, sweet and a must-try.



TAIWAN BLENDS SCENIC BEAUTY, MODERN INFRASTRUCTURE AND UNFORGETTABLE CULINARY EXPERIENCES FOR TRAVELLERS

The Art of Living completes 45 years of global service

TEAM AGENDA

As The Art of Living marked 45 years of humanitarian service and global outreach, the organisation celebrated the occasion with the launch of five major initiatives focused on youth empowerment, entrepreneurship, sustainability, consciousness studies, and education. The event, held at The Art of Living International Center, also coincided with the 70th birthday celebrations of Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, whose teachings on peace, well-being, and human values have influenced millions across the world.

Vice President of India CP Radhakrishnan presided over the launch ceremony and joined dignitaries in unveiling a commemorative postal stamp on the occasion.

The newly launched initiatives — the Youth Career Excellence Programme, Faculty of Eastern Knowledge Systems, Art of Living Innovation and Entrepreneurship Incubation, Centre of Excellence on Consciousness Studies and Human Potential, and Eco Shanti — reflect the organisation's expanding vision in addressing contemporary social, educational, environmental, and human development challenges.

The launch ceremony marked the culmination of month-long celebrations at The Art of Living International Center, attended by 678 distinguished guests from India and abroad.

Addressing the gathering, CP Radhakrishnan spoke about the extraordinary global reach of the movement founded by Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar.

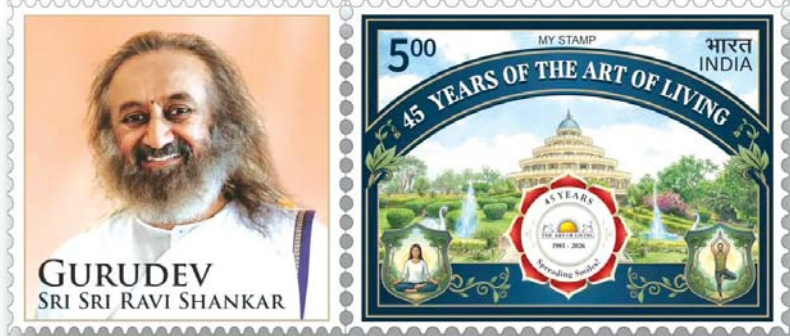
“Today is a celebration of a great vision that has touched millions of lives across continents. I was astonished to learn that The Art of Living is present in 182 countries. Almost the entire civilisation of mankind is getting linked through this movement,” he said.

Praising Gurudev's simplicity and compassion, the Vice President remarked that what made his contribution extraordinary was “the humility and humanity he embodies”.

Welcoming the Vice President and guests, Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar highlighted the growing global recognition of meditation and inner well-being in modern life. “The world today has recognised that meditation is no longer a luxury. With 192 countries coming together to declare World Meditation Day, there is a growing understanding that meditation is a basic necessity for a healthy, happy, and stress-free life,” Gurudev said.

Emphasising holistic human development, he noted that “knowledge, meditation, and music” must accompany people throughout life.

Gurudev concluded with a call for global harmony rooted in the ancient Indian ideal of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam — One World Family. “Let us dream of a world free from fear, tension, and hatred. A peaceful and harmonious world begins with peaceful and harmonious individ-



(L-R) Karnataka Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot, Vice President of India CP Radhakrishnan, and Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar at the Art of Living International Center

uals,” he said. Governor of Karnataka Thaawarchand Gehlot also addressed the gathering, highlighting Karnataka's connection to the origins of the global movement. “It is a matter of pride for Karnataka that the roots of this global movement are connected to our sacred land. For more than four decades, The Art of Living has promoted peace and well-being at the individual, community, and global levels through a variety of programmes,” he said. The Governor also praised Gurudev's contribution to peace-building efforts across the world.

The five initiatives launched during the event aim to address some of the most pressing needs of contemporary society through innovation, education, sustainability, and human development.

The Youth Career Excellence Program seeks to prepare young people for careers in the civil services while also providing industry-oriented hospitality training to improve employability among rural and urban youth.

The Faculty of Eastern Knowledge Systems will function as a multidisciplinary platform integrating Eastern wisdom traditions with modern education and research to address ethical, social, and ecological challenges.

The Art of Living Innovation and Entrepreneurship Incubation initiative aims to support innovation-driven and hardware-focused start-ups through mentorship, prototyping facilities, and early-stage funding, with a vision to nurture 500 start-ups.

Meanwhile, the Centre of Excellence

on Consciousness Studies and Human Potential will create an interdisciplinary ecosystem for research and innovation in consciousness, cognition, mental well-being, and human potential.

Eco Shanti, the organisation's sustainability initiative, seeks to eliminate single-use plastics through sustainable alternatives and aims to reduce plastic production and usage by at least 100,000 tonnes annually by 2030.

For nearly a month, The Art of Living International Center hosted a series of celebrations reflecting the spirit of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam. The event drew participation from prominent personalities across politics, business, spirituality, arts, and public life.

Among those who joined the celebrations were Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Ministers Nitin Gadkari and Sarbananda Sonowal, Maharashtra Chief Minister Shri Devendra Fadnavis, along with leading diplomats, scholars, faith leaders, and artists.

The month-long celebrations featured global meditations at the newly inaugurated Dhyana Mandir, cultural performances celebrating India's artistic heritage, discussions on mental well-being and consciousness, and stories of transformation from people whose lives have been impacted by Gurudev's work over the past 45 years. At its core, the celebration reaffirmed Gurudev Sri Sri Ravi Shankar's enduring vision of building a stress-free, violence-free society rooted in inner peace, service, compassion, and human values.

One World: One Family

In a world increasingly troubled by war, division and uncertainty, the ancient ideal of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, One World, One Family' feels more relevant than ever before. At a time when humanity is often fragmented by borders, beliefs and conflicts, the BAPS Hindu Mandir Abu Dhabi stands as a living embodiment of this timeless vision. Through its message and service, the mandir quietly reminds the world that humanity flourishes not through division, but through unity



DR SWAMI GYANANANDDAS

On the evening of April 2, 2024, as the golden lights of Abu Dhabi slowly merged into the serenity of the Ramadan twilight, an extraordinary scene unfolded within the sacred stone corridors of the BAPS Hindu Mandir Abu Dhabi. Bathed in radiant illumination and adorned with elegant decorations along every pathway, the mandir blossomed into a special celebration. On this special evening, the mandir opened its doors for 'Omsiyyat', an Arabic word evoking an intimate gathering of heart-felt conversation, reflection and companionship.

What followed was far more than a ceremonial gathering. Within the serene mandir complex, alive with the spirit of timeless Indian culture and spirituality, more than 200 distinguished guests from different faiths and nationalities gathered shoulder to shoulder. Hindu swamis, Muslim scholars, Christian priests, Jewish rabbis, Bahá'í representatives, diplomats, ministers and community leaders sat together not as representatives of separate religions, but as members of one human family.

Among them were His Excellency Sheikh Nahayan bin Mubarak Al Nahyan, UAE Minister of Tolerance and Coexistence; His Excellency Dr Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi; and His Excellency Dr Mugheer Khamis Al Khaili, leaders whose presence itself reflected the UAE's larger vision of harmony. Rabbi Jeff Berger of the Abrahamic Family House captured the spirit of the evening beautifully when he observed that “unity in diversity is not merely a principle, but a practice”. And on that evening, the practice became visible.

Then came perhaps the most moving moment of all. As the Ramadan fast con-

WITHIN THE SERENE MANDIR COMPLEX, ALIVE WITH THE SPIRIT OF TIMELESS INDIAN CULTURE AND SPIRITUALITY, MORE THAN 200 DISTINGUISHED GUESTS FROM DIFFERENT FAITHS AND NATIONALITIES GATHERED SHOULDER TO SHOULDER

cluded, leaders of different religions gathered to share suhoor together in the mandir complex. Volunteers lovingly served pure vegetarian Indian and Arabic delicacies, simple meals transformed into symbols of coexistence. Around the dining tables, differences of race, language, nationality and belief quietly dissolved into conversation, laughter and mutual respect. It was diplomacy without negotiations, peace without slogans and spirituality without barriers.

Addressing the gathering, Sheikh Nahayan bin Mubarak Al Nahyan spoke with rare conviction. At a time when the world is threatened by “separatism, distrust, intolerance and conflicts”, he said, the mandir brings “hope to the world”. His words carried the weight of a deeper truth that humanity survives not through power alone, but through coexistence.

Swami Brahmaviharidas (Head, BAPS Mandir Abu Dhabi), speaking on behalf of the mandir and inspired by the guidance of Guru Mahant Swami Maharaj, expressed gratitude to His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan and the UAE leadership for nurturing such a vision of harmony. Reflecting on the atmosphere of the evening, he shared a striking thought once voiced

by a scientist: that if humanity were ever judged by visitors from another world, he would rather they judge Earth by what was happening in Abu Dhabi that evening than by the wars and monuments of hatred scattered across the globe.

And perhaps that was the true significance of Omsiyyat. It was not merely an interfaith programme. It was a quiet yet powerful declaration that the ancient Indian ideal of “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, The World Is One Family”, is not an unreachable philosophy.

That same spirit continued to reveal itself even during recent wartime anxieties across the Gulf. On the soil of the UAE, the leadership of the nation and the swamis of the BAPS Hindu Mandir Abu Dhabi came together in a shared effort of care, prayer and humanitarian support for stranded and distressed families, a living reflection that, in moments of fear and uncertainty, One World, One Family is not merely spoken, but lived.

Reinforcing the UAE's enduring commitment to coexistence and human unity, Swami Brahmaviharidas was recently received by His Highness Sheikh Mohammed bin Hamad Al Nahyan, Adviser to the President of the UAE and Chairman of Abu Dhabi Airports. In a warm and meaningful exchange, Swami Brahmaviharidas expressed gratitude for the visionary leadership of His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan in nurturing an environment of stability, security, equality and mutual respect for people of all faiths and nationalities across the UAE. His Highness, in turn, appreciated the mandir's growing role as a beacon of peace, harmony and shared humanity, advancing values that continue to unite hearts beyond cultural and religious boundaries.

Yet, beyond official meetings and ceremonial exchanges, something far deeper has quietly taken root. The mandir has now become a sacred thread of relationship between the UAE leadership and the Hindu swamis. Their bond, built upon mutual respect, trust, care and shared ideals, has evolved into a living expression of “Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam, One World, One Family”, a rare and inspiring symbol of harmony between two nations, two cultures and two faith traditions.

(The writer Dr Swami Gyanananddas is a dedicated follower of the Swaminarayan tradition and has earned a PhD from MS University)



Weekly Overview
The week opens under an intense Scorpio Moon, bringing deeper reactions and stronger internal processing. Midweek, Sagittarius increases movement, communication and outward thinking. By the weekend, Capricorn shifts focus toward discipline, responsibility and practical decision-making.

Aries (Mesh): Early developments may prompt deeper reflection, particularly in financial or emotional matters where clarity has been delayed. Reactions around you may feel stronger than expected, making patience more valuable than confrontation. Midweek brings movement, discussions and fresh momentum, especially in work or travel plans. By the weekend, practical responsibilities demand attention, and discipline becomes essential.

Taurus (Vrisabha): Relationships and interpersonal dynamics may demand greater attention during the opening phase of the week. Others may appear emotionally intense or difficult to read, so avoid reacting too quickly to changing behaviour. Midweek supports practical thinking, communication and clearer planning, particularly where pending decisions require movement. Weekend brings clarity and confidence; stubbornness may slow progress.

Gemini (Mithun): Routine matters and unfinished responsibilities may dominate the opening days, making it important to avoid distraction or scattered effort. Emotional undercurrents in the workplace or within close interactions may require calmer handling. Midweek brings stronger movement, conversations and opportunities to reconnect with people or plans that had slowed earlier. By the weekend, practical judgment matters. Avoid emotional decisions.

WEEKLY MOON SIGN FORECAST | 31 MAY - 6 JUNE
Strong Reactions, Expanding Thoughts and Grounded Decisions
Dr Shanker Adawal
Astrologer, Author & Researcher
This forecast is based on your Moon Sign (Janma Rashi), which often reflects day-to-day emotional and instinctive patterns more closely than general Sun-sign readings.

Cancer (Karka): The week begins with stronger emotional intensity, though this may also improve creativity, intuition and personal involvement in important matters. However, emotional reactions could become heavier if expectations remain too rigid. Midweek shifts attention toward routine responsibilities, health matters or work structure requiring practical balance. By the weekend, relationships and communication improve, though emotional maturity will still be necessary in sensitive discussions. Listen more, explain less.

Leo (Simha): Domestic matters, emotional comfort or unresolved personal concerns may shape the opening phase of the week. You may prefer distance from unnecessary noise or social pressure for a while. Midweek brings renewed confidence, movement and stronger external engagement, making this a useful phase for communication and practical progress. By the weekend, routine responsibilities and pending commitments may demand greater discipline. Avoid postponing practical matters that have already waited too long.

Virgo (Kanya): Conversations and communication may carry stronger emotional weight during the opening days, particularly where misunderstandings or assumptions already exist. This is not the best phase for impulsive

reactions. Midweek supports movement, learning, planning and broader thinking, helping mental pressure settle gradually. By the weekend, emotional stability improves and creative thinking becomes stronger. Practical judgment remains important, while confidence steadies.

Libra (Tula): Financial thinking or practical concerns may require greater attention during the early part of the week. Emotional spending or unnecessary commitments should be avoided. Midweek brings stronger social movement and improved communication, though not every opinion around you will require a response. By the weekend, family matters or emotional responsibilities may need patient handling. Maintaining balance between personal expectations and practical realities will become important.

Scorpio (Vrischik): With the Moon opening the week in Scorpio, emotional awareness, observation and personal intensity naturally increase. This can help you recognise what has remained unresolved beneath the surface. However, reactions may become stronger if control is pushed too far. Midweek gradually lightens mental pressure and supports practical movement in financial or work-related matters. By the weekend, communication improves, though measured words will still produce better results than emotional insistence.

Sagittarius (Dhanu): The opening phase may feel mentally crowded, with emotional or practical matters demanding quiet observation before action becomes possible. Midweek becomes your stronger phase, as the Moon enters Sagittarius and restores movement, confidence and outward

momentum. Travel, planning or meaningful discussions may move more naturally during this period. By the weekend, financial discipline and Practical matters return to focus. Excitement alone may not be enough.

Capricorn (Makar): Social expectations, group discussions or professional coordination may dominate the opening phase of the week. Emotional reactions from others could require diplomacy rather than direct confrontation. Midweek supports planning and broader perspective, though overcommitting should still be avoided. By the weekend, the Moon enters Capricorn, restoring steadiness, discipline and clearer personal judgment. This is the strongest phase of the week for organised effort and practical correction.

Aquarius (Kumbh): Responsibilities or professional expectations may feel heavier during the opening days, particularly where emotional pressure and practical demands become mixed together. Midweek brings improved communication and stronger support through discussions, planning or collaboration. However, not every opportunity needs immediate commitment. By the weekend, emotional energy becomes quieter and more inward-looking. Some matters may benefit from patience and observation before important conclusions are reached.

Pisces (Meen): The week opens with deeper thinking, emotional reflection and a stronger need to understand situations beyond surface appearances. Midweek supports movement, communication and practical progress, especially in work or responsibility-driven matters. However, expectations should remain realistic. By the weekend, social interactions become constructive, helping pressure ease. Practical discipline remains necessary, but balance becomes easier to maintain.